

AAPL DEF 14A (2026-01-08)

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(Name of Registrant as Specified in Its Charter) (Name of Person(s) Filing Proxy Statement, if other than the Registrant) Payment of Filing Fee (Check all boxes that apply): No fee required. Fee paid previously with preliminary materials. Fee computed on table in exhibit required by Item 25(b) per Exchange Act Rules 14a-6(i)(1) and 0-11. Table of Contents Table of Contents Attending the Annual Meeting We are pleased to welcome shareholders to the 2026 Annual Meeting, ~~which will be held virtually on February 24, 2026, at 10:00 a.m. Pacific Standard Time.~~ ~~For more information, please visit~~ ~~www.virtualshareholdermeeting.com/AAPL2026~~ and enter the control number included in your Availability of Proxy Materials, voting instruction form, or proxy card. Online access to the webcast will open approximately

15 minutes prior to the start of the Annual Meeting. Attendance at the Annual Meeting is subject to capacity limits at the virtual meeting platform provider. To submit questions in advance of the Annual Meeting, visit proxyvote.com before 8:59 P.M. Pacific Time on February 23, 2026, and enter your control number. Your vote is important to us. We encourage you to vote your shares

in advance online, as well as by telephone or in person at the Annual Meeting. You

may also vote by mail. For more detailed information, visit proxyvote.com

beginning on page 87 of the Proxy Statement. In the Proxy Statement, the terms "Apple," "we," "us," and "our" refer to Apple Inc.

Information presented in the Proxy Statement and Company documents refers to Apple Inc.

based on Apple's 2025 fiscal year, unless otherwise indicated.

Directors and executive officers, which refer to calendar

statements to additional material disclosures on those websites. These websites and materials

reference to the Proxy Statement or in any other Securities and Exchange Commission filing we make under

the Securities Exchange Act of 1934, as amended. This document includes

forward-looking statements regarding our business, financial condition, results of operations, and

and goals, and our executive compensation program. These statements involve risks and uncertainties.

Actual results may differ materially from any future results expressed or implied by the forward-looking statements for a variety

of reasons, including due to the risks, uncertainties, and other important factors that are discussed in our most recently

periodic reports on Form 10-K and Form 10-Q and subsequent Securities and Exchange Commission filings. We

cannot predict future results, and the forward-looking statements, which speak only as of the date they are made.

Apple and the Apple logo are trademarks of Apple Inc., registered in

January 8, 2026. Table of Contents Table of Contents Notice of 2026 Annual Meeting of Shareholders

Summary 2025 Business Highlights Executive Compensation Shareholder Engagement

9 Nominees to Apple's Board of Directors Progress Across our Values Items of

Business and Board Voting Recommendations Corporate Governance Our Corporate Governance

Framework Role of the Board of Directors Board Independence Board and Committee

Structure Board Oversight Board Meetings and Attendance 20 Annual Board and

Committee Self-Evaluations 20 Related Party Policy and Transactions 20 Business Conduct Policy

21 Communications with the Board 21 Directors 23 Board Composition and Evaluation of Candidates

24 Nominees for Election 25 Compensation of Directors 31 Executive Officers 33

Executive Compensation 35 Message from the People and Compensation Committee 37

Compensation Discussion and Analysis 38 People and Compensation Committee Report 51 Executive

Compensation Tables 52 Management Proposals 63 Proposal No. 1 - Election of Directors 64

Proposal No. 2 - Ratification of Appointment of Independent Registered Public Accounting Firm 65 Proposal No. 3

- Advisory Vote to Approve Executive Compensation 67 Proposal No. 4 - Approval of the Apple Inc.

Non-Employee Director Stock Plan, as Amended and Restated 68 Shareholder Proposals

73 Shareholder Proposals 74 Identification of Proponents 74 Vote Required 74 Proposal

No. 5 75 Other Information 79 Audit and Finance Committee Report 80 Security Ownership of

Certain Beneficial Owners and Management 81 Equity Compensation Plan Information 83

General Information 84 Annex A A-1 Table of Contents Notice of 2026 Annual Meeting of

Shareholders Date and Time Virtual Meeting Site Who Can Vote February 24, 2026

8:00 A.M. Pacific Time www.virtualshareholdermeeting.com/AAPL2026 Shareholders of

record at the close of business on January 2, 2026 Items of Business and Board Voting Recommendations

1 Election of Directors: Wanda Austin, Tim Cook, Alex Gorsky, Andrea Jung, Art Levinson, Monica

Lozano, Ron Sugar, and Sue Wagner FOR 2 Ratification of Appointment of Independent Registered

Public Accounting Firm FOR 3 Advisory Vote to Approve Executive Compensation FOR 4

Approval of the Apple Inc. Non-Employee Director Stock Plan, as Amended and Restated FOR 5

Shareholder Proposal if properly presented AGAINST And other business as may properly come before

the Annual Meeting. Sincerely, Kate Adams Senior Vice President,

Secretary Counsel and

the Annual Meeting of Shareholders to be held on February 24, 2026. The Notice of Meeting, Proxy Statement,

Annual Report, and Form 10-K are available free of charge at proxyvote.com and at investor.apple.com. Table of Contents

of Proxy Materials re continuously inspired by the

magazines, create

communities. - Tim Cook, CEO Table of

Chief Executive Officer To our shareholders, This has been an exceptional

[illegible]

accessibility has been built into our products from the start. That commitment began in 1985, when Apple established its first office dedicated to accessibility. That commitment continues today across every product we make. Accessibility is a core part of our DNA, and we are committed to building products that are built on the foundation of meaningful ways. The all-new Magnifier for Mac gives users a way to interact with the physical world; letting them use Mac to interact with documents, whiteboards, and more. And with Braille Access, users can turn their iPhone, iPad, Mac, and Apple Vision Pro into a full-featured braille note taker, enabling them to launch applications, documents, and more. These products, along with many others, reflect our belief that technology should work for everyone. We are proud to build products that empower people of all abilities to connect, create, and do more of what they love, and we're committed to pushing accessibility forward.

Summary of the Board of Directors' Proposed 2026 Proxy Statement Table of Contents

Board Voting Recommendations; Proposal; Board Recommendation; Page; Reference 1; Election of Directors; All of our directors are elected annually for a one-year term. Our Board is made up of directors with a broad range of skills and experiences to effectively address Apple's evolving needs and represent the best interests of Apple's shareholders. FOR 64 2; Ratification of Appointment of Independent Registered Public Accounting Firm Ernst & Young LLP is an independent auditing firm with the required knowledge and experience to effectively audit Apple's financial statements. Audit and non-audit services are pre-approved by the Audit and Finance Committee. FOR 65 3; Advisory Vote to Approve Executive Compensation; Our executive compensation program is designed to align pay with shareholder interests and company performance. The compensation paid to our named executive officers in 2025 reflects the strength of our annual financial results and stock price performance. FOR 67 4; Approval of the Apple Inc. Non-Employee Director Stock Plan, as amended and restated 2027; The proposed amendment would extend the term of the Plan to February 23, 2036. The requested report is unnecessary given we already provide extensive information on our international operations. The proposal is highly prescriptive and attempts to inappropriately restrict Apple's ability to manage its own ordinary business operations and business strategies. AGAINST 75 12

2026 Proxy Statement Table of Contents

Summary Governance Directors Compensation Proposals Other Information; Corporate Governance; Our Corporate Governance Framework 14 Role of the Board of Directors 15 Board Independence 15 Board and Committee Structure 15 Board Oversight 17 Board Meetings and Attendance 20 Annual Board and Committee Self-Evaluations 20 Related Party Policy and Transactions 20 Business Conduct Policy 21 Communications with the Board 21

Apple's Key Governance Documents

Apple's key governance documents, including our Corporate Governance Guidelines, are available on Apple's corporate website at <https://www.apple.com/governance/>. One share equals one vote. We have a single class of shares with equal voting rights. Annual director elections. All directors are elected annually for a one-year term. Majority voting. We have a majority voting standard for uncontested elections of directors. Separation of Chair and CEO roles. Our CEO is focused on managing Apple and our independent Chair drives accountability at the Board level. Stock ownership guidelines. We have robust stock ownership guidelines for our directors and executive officers. Shareholder engagement. We have a comprehensive year-round shareholder engagement program. Access to management. Our Board has significant interaction with senior management and access to other employees. Time commitment policy. The Nominating and Corporate Governance Committee annually reviews each director's various time commitments. Financial expertise. The Board has determined that each Audit and Finance Committee member qualifies as an audit committee financial expert, as that term is defined under SEC rules. Continuing education. Our Board regularly receives updates on ethics, compliance, and governance as well as emerging topics relevant to the evolving needs of the Company. Succession planning. Our Board regularly reviews Board and executive succession planning. Executive sessions. All quarterly Board and committee meetings include executive sessions during which no members of management are present. Board, committee, and individual self-evaluations. Our Board, committees, and individual directors conduct annual performance self-evaluations led by our independent Chair, including one-on-one interviews. Prohibitions on hedging, pledging, and other transactions. We prohibit short sales, transactions in derivatives, and hedging of Apple securities by directors, executive officers, and employees, and prohibit pledging of Apple securities by directors and

executive officers. Special meetings Shareholders owning at least 10% of our outstanding shares have the right to call a special meeting of the shareholders. Proxy access Up to 20 shareholders owning at least 3% of our outstanding shares continuously for three years may nominate up to 20% of our Board. 14 2026 Proxy Statement Table of Contents Summary Governance Directors Compensation Proposals Other Information Role of the Board of Directors Apple’s Board oversees the CEO and other

interests of shareholders. The competent and ethical operation of Apple and seeks to ensure that the long-term is committed to our business success. Directors are expected to take a proactive, focused approach to ensure Apple through independence. Apple’s Board of Directors Corporate Governance Guidelines Board independence. The Board has determined that all Board members, other than Mr. Cook, are independent. The Nasdaq Stock Market LLC (“Nasdaq”). Apple’s Board has a standing Audit

“People and Compensation Committee (the “Audit Committee”), People and Compensation Committee (the “Nominating Committee”), and Nominating and Corporate Governance Committee (the

Apple’s Board of Directors and Securities Exchange Commission members are independent under

on this issue (“SEC”). Committee also meets the

104A3(b)(1) independence Securities Exchange Act of 1934, as amended (the

“Exchange Act”). “SEC” regularly reviews the Board’s leadership

and composition of its standing committees. The structure and composition of Apple’s Board

are intended to leverage the wide range of perspectives of the Board members and promote effective oversight.

The Board believes its current leadership

Apple’s Vision of overall corporate structure and the separated, best serves

behalf of Apple’s shareholders, including its responsibilities on

oversight of the company and corporate governance matters. The

independent Chair of Apple, who is responsible for giving a

level of the current membership and

accepted by the Board, described on the following page. Each committee operates under a written charter

is available at [apple.com/leadership](#). Proxy Statement Table of Contents Summary Governance

Directors Compensation Proposals Other Information Audit Committee Ron Sugar (Chair) Wanda Austin

Monica Lozano Sue Wagner Nine meetings during 2025 Audit Committee Report: page 80

Primary Responsibilities: ● Assist the Board in oversight and monitoring of Apple’s financial statements

and other financial information ● Oversee compliance with legal, regulatory, and public disclosure requirements

● Appoint and oversee Apple’s independent registered public accounting firm, including their qualifications

and independence, and pre-approve fees ● Oversee Apple’s systems of internal controls, including the

internal audit function ● Oversee treasury and finance matters ● Oversee enterprise risk management

● Oversee privacy and data security ● Oversee the auditing, accounting, and financial reporting process

 People and Compensation Committee Andrea Jung (Chair) Alex Gorsky Art Levinson Five

meetings during 2025 People and Compensation Committee Report: page 51 Primary

Responsibilities: ● Review and approve the compensation arrangements for the CEO, Apple’s other

executive officers and, to the extent it deems appropriate, other employees ● Administer Apple’s equity

compensation and other incentive plans ● Review and make recommendations to the Board regarding the

compensation of members of the Board and Board committees ● Assist the Board in its oversight of

Apple’s strategies, policies, and practices relating to Apple’s people and teams Nominating

Committee Sue Wagner (Chair) Alex Gorsky Andrea Jung Four meetings during 2025

 Primary Responsibilities: ● Assist the Board on matters relating to the identification, evaluation, and

selection of Board members and candidates nominated to the Board ● Make recommendations to the Board

concerning the size, structure, and composition of the Board and its committees ● Oversee and make

recommendations regarding corporate governance matters, including Apple’s Corporate Governance Guidelines

● Assist the Board in its oversight of Apple’s strategies, policies, and practices relating to environmental

and social matters ● Oversee the annual Board performance self-evaluation process 16

2026 Proxy Statement Table of Contents Summary Governance Directors Compensation Proposals Other

Information Board Oversight The Board takes an active role in overseeing

and seeks to protect the long-term interests of Apple and its shareholders are being served. The

Evaluating the executive team’s management of the risks confronting Apple is one of its most important

oversight. In carrying out this responsibility, the Board is assisted by its committees, each of which considers risks

within areas of primary responsibility and expertise and apprises the full Board of significant matters and

management’s

response. Board of Directors Directly oversees corporate and product strategy,

executive succession planning, and other matters reserved to the full Board. Reviews and discusses with management significant risks affecting Apple, including matters escalated by its committees from within their respective areas of direct oversight. Audit Committee Oversees financial matters, business conduct, legal and regulatory compliance, privacy, cybersecurity,

and risk. People and Compensation Committee Oversees the design and administration of equity plans and executive compensation programs and policies and has primary responsibility

for matters relating to Apple’s people and teams. Nominating Committee Oversees Board structure, governance, and independence, and has primary responsibility for assisting the Board with oversight

and social matters, including public policy expenditures. Management Led by our CEO and

executive team, develops and executes our business strategy, manages operations, implements and supervises

day-to-day risk management processes, and reports to the Board and its committees on significant matters.

Internal Audit Directly overseen by the Audit Committee and operating pursuant to a charter, which is reviewed

and approved annually by the Audit Committee, identifies and helps mitigate risk, and improves internal controls.

Enterprise Risk Management Program Designed to identify, assess, and monitor Apple’s business risks, including financial, operational, compliance, and reputational risks.

Supported by Financial Officer, General Counsel, Chief of Business Assurance, and other senior leaders, that assists the

Audit Committee with its general responsibility for overseeing enterprise risk management.

2026 Proxy Statement 17 Table of Contents Summary Governance Directors Compensation Proposals

Other Information Selected Areas of Oversight Board

Board regularly reviews Board and executive succession planning. The Board considers oversight of executive succession

the Board to be one of its primary duties, and in planning the Board regularly evaluates the composition of

Apple’s long-term strategic goals and monitors the Board’s mix of skills, backgrounds, and experiences

to help ensure that the Board is well-equipped to perform its oversight function effectively. The Nominating

Committee is responsible for coordinating and overseeing the annual Board evaluation process, which includes reviewing

the skills and qualifications of individual directors, as well as reviewing the Board’s structure as a whole to

determine if the Board and its committees are functioning effectively. People and Teams The Board oversees

matters related to our people and teams, including with respect to inclusion and diversity, culture and employee

engagement, talent recruitment, development, and retention, and has allocated direct responsibilities for this area of

oversight to the People and Compensation Committee. Additionally, Apple’s People and Compensation

Committee oversees risks related to Apple’s compensation programs.

Each year, the People and Compensation Committee reviews the design and operation of Apple’s compensation

programs to ensure they do not encourage employees to take unnecessary or excessive risks. In establishing

Apple’s compensation programs for risk, the People and Compensation Committee considers program

features

that mitigate potential risks for our executive officers, such as fixed base salaries; goals that are tied to specific

financial measures and payout caps for the annual cash incentive program; clawbacks for our cash and equity

requirements. The People and Compensation Committee also generally considers program features that

mitigate potential risks for our

non-executive officer employees. Annual review, the People and Compensation

and compensation committees help ensure continue to provide an effective

performance short-term risk taking at the expense value creation, and do

not create adverse effect on Apple’s compliance reasonably likely to have a

discuss with management Apple’s compliance and business conduct programs,

including on privacy, political compliance, and other legal and regulatory risks. Apple’s

legal department oversees legal and regulatory developments, including updates on legislative developments,

investigations, litigation, and other legal proceedings. 18 2026 Proxy Statement Table of Contents Summary Governance Directors Compensation Proposals Other Information Privacy and Data Security

The Audit Committee regularly reviews and discusses with management Apple’s privacy and data security risks.

The Audit Committee receives regular updates from management, including Apple’s Head of Corporate

Information Security. Additionally, the Audit Committee reviews updates on privacy and data security matters from

Apple’s General Counsel, Chief Compliance Officer, and the heads of Business Assurance and Internal Audit.

 Apple also has a management Privacy Steering Committee chaired by Apple’s General Counsel, with

members including Apple’s Senior Vice President of Software Engineering, Apple’s Senior Vice President,

Services, and a cross-functional group of senior representatives from Privacy Engineering, Product Marketing, Corporate

Communications, and Privacy Legal. The Privacy Steering Committee sets privacy standards for teams across Apple and

acts as an escalation point for addressing privacy compliance issues for decision or further escalation. Online Safety

 The Board reviews regular updates from management relating to online safety. These updates cover a range of topics, including updates on regulatory and enforcement issues and on features designed to help keep users safe online. Apple also has a management Online Safety Steering Committee chaired by Apple’s General Counsel, with members including

Marketing, The Consumer Software Engineering, Child Safety Engineering, Trust & Safety, and Product children, Artificial Intelligence Apple ’s full Board directly oversees corporate and product strategy and receives regular updates on emerging technologies, including artificial intelligence. These updates cover a broad range of matters, such as strategy, investments, partnerships, regulation, and risks. The Audit Committee assists the Board in its oversight of privacy-related artificial intelligence matters, as well as legal and regulatory risks related to artificial intelligence. The Company has published Responsible AI principles, which aim to guide how the Company develops artificial intelligence tools, as well as the models that underpin them. The principles are available at: machinelearning.apple.com/research/introducing-apple-foundation-models . Human Rights The Board has adopted a human rights policy for Apple — Our Commitment to Human Rights. The policy governs how we treat

supply chain including our customers and teams, business partners and communities, and people at every level of our Apple with Apple’s Human Rights Policy, which is based on the United Nations Guiding Principles, Apple works to mitigate through risk assessments and through channels we maintain with stakeholders. reports findings identified and the to remedy adverse impacts, track and measure progress, and the stakeholders. The Board Rights Policy Apple’s General overseeing and periodically reviewing our Human Ourselves responsible for significant implementation, and reports to the Board Elevated during the Climate The Board Apple’s progress review and discuss updates on environmental matters with senior management responsible for the development, review, and execution of plans designed to minimize Apple’s impact on the environment. These reports include updates on Apple’s progress towards environmental and climate goals and the environmental impact of our products and operations. Apple reports publicly on its efforts and progress across its environmental initiatives through an annual Environmental Progress Report. Supply Chain The Board and its committees review and discuss with management reports regarding Apple’s supply chain and operations.

Supply chain and operations from Apple’s Chief Operating Officer on Apple’s the platform across its groups in their critical work on protecting people and Apple 2025 Proxy C160 Statement 19 Tables of Contents Summary Governance Directors Compensation Proposals Other Information Board Meetings and Attendance The Board of the Board during 2025. During 2025 attended or participated in 75% or more of the aggregate of meetings of the Board held during 2025, and (ii) the total number of meetings Board of which the member served during 2025. Apple All directors attended the 2025 and the Annual Meeting of the Shareholders (the “2025 Annual Meeting ”). The the Board and its committees self-evaluation members of the Board are working effectively improve provides as appropriate The Evaluation of committees and its established independent Chair of the Board, assists the Chair in on one-on-one discussions with each effectiveness and performance of the Board and its committees. Additional discussion composition, Board refreshment, timing, agendas, and content of Board and dynamics and functions of the Board reviews of other members; and the Board’s oversight of executive planning. Board members are also invited to discuss the performance of Dr. Levinson directly with the Chair of the

Non-voting Committee. A summary identifying any themes or issues that have emerged is presented to the Board on Basis Each committee’s evaluation includes

Apple’s Board of Directors General “Guidelines and the committees’ The Transactions The Board has adopted a written policy for director nominees, executive officers, and the 5% beneficial owners of Apple’s equity securities, and each of their respective involved in the transaction, exceeds the reasonably expected to exceed \$120,000 partying to it will have and direct or indirect interest in the transaction (other than solely 1% beneficial being a direct or indirect). A copy of this policy is available at apple.com/leadership-and-governance . The policy provides that the subject to the policy, and determines whether to approve or ratify those transactions. Certain types of transactions are

deemed pre-approved pursuant to standing pre-approval guidelines established by the Audit Committee. The Audit Committee has delegated authority to its Chair to pre-approve or ratify transactions under certain circumstances, including transactions covered by standing pre-approvals or transactions approved or ratified by the Committee, if any, is provided to the Audit Committee for its review. In reviewing transactions subject to the policy, the Audit Committee considers the following information:

- The nature and terms of the transaction;
- The approximate dollar value involved in the transaction;
- The approximate dollar value of the related person's interest in the transaction without regard to the amount of any profit or loss;
- Whether the transaction was undertaken in the ordinary course of Apple's business;
- The material terms of the transaction, including whether the transaction with the related person is proposed to be, or was entered into, on terms no less favorable to Apple than terms that could have been reached with an unrelated third party;
- The business purpose of, and the potential benefits to Apple of, the transaction;
- Whether the transaction would impair the independence of a non-employee director;
- Required public disclosure, if any; and
- Any other information regarding the transaction or the related person in the context of the proposed transaction that would be material to the Audit Committee's decision, in its business judgment, in light of the circumstances of the particular transaction.

Several of Apple's Board members and executive officers are directors or executive officers of other organizations, including organizations with which Apple has commercial relationships. Apple does not believe that any director had a direct or indirect material interest in any such relationship during the year ended September 28, 2024. A family member of our principal executive officer received total compensation in excess of \$120,000 for the year ended September 28, 2024, which compensation was disclosed in the Proxy Statement. The family member has comparable qualifications, experience and holding similar positions of responsibility at other organizations. Apple's business conduct principles, which apply to all employees, including Apple's principal executive officer, principal financial officer, and principal contractors, officers and directors, are set forth in the code also apply to the Board. Apple expects its suppliers and service providers to follow the principles set forth in the code when providing goods and services to Apple. The code is available at <https://www.apple.com/legal/privacy/2017/apple-business-conduct-policy.pdf>.

Apple intends to disclose any material disclosure required by the SEC or any other applicable regulatory authority. Apple's code is managed by the Board of Directors and is subject to the oversight of Apple's Chief Compliance Officer. Employees are required to complete training on the code and executive leadership regularly. With input from relevant stakeholders, Apple's Board of Directors provides guidance related to the code to employees, executive officers, and directors. Additionally, Apple's Board of Directors is responsible for reviewing all Apple purchases, sales, and dispositions of Apple's securities that are made by Apple's employees and its executive officers. Apple also follows a policy designed to prohibit trading of Apple securities by its employees and executive officers. This policy is applicable to Apple's employees and executive officers and is available at <https://www.apple.com/legal/privacy/2017/apple-business-conduct-policy.pdf>. Apple's insider trading policy was filed as Exhibit 9.1 to the proxy statement for the 2024 Annual Meeting of Shareholders held on September 28, 2024.

Communications with the Board

Any matter intended for the Board, or for any director, should be directed to Apple's Secretary at One Apple Park, Cupertino, CA 95014, USA. Any shareholder communication intended to be delivered to the intended recipient in accordance with the instructions of the Board should be directed to the intended recipient. Apple reserves the right to remove or to Board members' materials. 2026 Proxy Statement 21 Table of Contents Summary Governance Directors Compensation Proposals Other Information Directors Board Composition and Evaluation of Candidates 24 Nominees for Election 25 Compensation of Directors 31 2026 Proxy Statement 23 Table of Contents Summary Governance Directors Compensation Proposals Other Information Board Composition and Evaluation of Candidates Board Composition Apple's Board consists of a highly qualified group of leaders with senior leadership experience and backgrounds. All of the directors have gained significant and varied experience in their current positions, including public company financial reporting, compliance, risk management, and leadership experience. They also have experience as executive officers, or on boards of directors and board committees, and a

robust understanding of corporate governance practices and trends. In addition, many of our directors have expertise as trustees of significant public policy, academic, research, non-profit, and philanthropic institutions, the benefit of these perspectives to the Board. The Board and the Nominating Committee believe the skills and experience of our directors provide Apple with business acumen and a broad range of perspectives to effectively address Apple's evolving needs, oversee senior management in the competent and ethical operation of Apple, and represent the best interests of Apple.

The Board regularly evaluates its composition and the qualifications of its members. The Board assesses each nominee's skills, backgrounds, experiences, and contributions in light of the Company's and the Company's evolving needs. Over the past four years, the Board has added three new members,

this year, one-third of its membership, and two other, long-serving members retired. In the context of

As a result of the Board's determination that it would be in the best interests of Apple and

for the election of the Board, and Ron Sugar, the Chair of the Audit Committee, to stand

after a full term of office, the Board determined which directors generally may not stand for re-election

the Board also considered several factors, including the significant

On the Board, the Board's deep insight into the

The Board also considers the benefits of continuity on the Board.

Corporate Governance Committee requires a review by the Nominating Committee of each director's various

the other director's primary occupation, service on other public company boards and board

organizations, as well as service with private company boards and non-profit

in 2025, the Nominating Committee determined that, in its view, no director

Nominating Committee has evaluated and recommended to the Board each of the nominees named in this Proxy Statement

Governance Director Compensation, Other Information, and Nominee Selection Process; The Nominating Committee oversees board succession

Planning and considers candidates who are recommended by the Nominating Committee;

shareholders and board members, as well as those identified by third-party search firms retained to

evaluating possible candidates. In evaluating potential nominees to the Board, the Nominating Committee

among other things: independence, character, ability to exercise sound judgment, demonstrated leadership, ability and

will be able to commit sufficient time to the Board, and relevant skills, backgrounds, and experiences in the context of

with a broad range of composition of the Board. The Nominating Committee is committed to including individuals

skills, backgrounds, and experiences. The Nominating Committee evaluates candidates to the Board

recommended applies to all candidates. Shareholders who wish to recommend

submit the candidate's name and background information in writing to our Secretary at One Apple

927466, Cupertino, CA 95014 USA. In addition, the proxy access provisions in our bylaws provide that a shareholder, or group of up to 20 shareholders, owning at least 3% of our outstanding shares continuously for at least three years, may nominate

Nominating shareholders may up to 20% of Apple's Board for inclusion in our proxy statement.

investor's relationship and governance in our bylaws, which can be found at

proxy access must include the additional information required

by Rules 15b-101 and 15b-102 of the Exchange Act. The following page highlights

the key skills and other factors that the Board and the Nominating Committee to

recommend to the Board. The matrix is intended to depict notable areas of focus for each director based

on the position of the Board, and not having a mark does not mean that a particular director does not possess that qualification

over his or her responsibilities developed competencies in these skills through education, direct experience, and

Additional biographical information on the directors; mix of skills on an annual basis.

2025 Proxy Statement, Table of Contents, Summary Governance Directors Compensation Proposals

Other Information; Nominee Skills; and

; Levinson; Cook; Austin; Gorsky; Jung; Lozano; Sugar;

Wagner;

; Core; Leadership Experience serving in a significant leadership position, including as a chief

executive officer, chief financial officer, or other senior leadership role, equips directors with valuable insight into

organizational behavior and processes and a deep understanding of the various aspects of modern organizations,

including strategic planning, financial reporting, compliance, values, and culture. Corporate Governance Experience on public company boards promotes an understanding of the dynamics and operation of a corporate board and its relationship with the chief executive officer and other senior management, as well as deep knowledge of corporate governance practices and policies and an appreciation of how they can impact Apple. Risk Management Experience identifying, managing, or mitigating risks develops a director's ability to effectively oversee Apple's risk management. Financial Knowledge of financial markets, financing, and financial reporting processes helps our directors understand and oversee our financial position, results of operations, and related financial reporting, as well as our broader financing activities and capital structure. Strategic People and Culture Because Apple operates in a competitive talent market, directors with experience managing people and teams, including recruitment, retention, development, compensation, and incentivization of key talent, provide strategic value in overseeing these areas and in determining compensation for our CEO and other senior leaders. Global Business and Operations Experience in global business and operations, including exposure to global business cultures, consumer preferences, and economic, regulatory, and political conditions, helps directors oversee Apple's global footprint and complex supply chain. Innovation and Technology Directors with an understanding of innovation and technology, through experience in technology-related businesses or driving scientific innovation, are strategically equipped to oversee Apple's innovation-focused product and services roadmap. Brand and Marketing Experience with the marketing and branding of products, building brand awareness, and enhancing corporate reputation can help directors successfully guide and advise management and oversee related efforts. Privacy and Security At Apple, we believe privacy is a fundamental human right. Directors with experience in information security, data privacy, and cybersecurity are uniquely qualified to oversee our product and services roadmap, as well as privacy and cybersecurity risks. Public Policy and Government Experience in government relations, regulatory matters, or regulated industries provides a valuable perspective as Apple operates in an increasingly regulated global environment. Environment and Climate At Apple, we believe business can and should be a force for good. Directors with experience leading efforts to mitigate environmental impacts are well qualified to oversee our environmental programs and product development.

2026 Proxy Statement Table of Contents Summary Governance Directors Compensation Proposals Other Information Art Levinson Chair of the Board Director since 2000 People and Compensation Committee Key Skills and Qualifications Art Levinson brings to the Board executive leadership experience, including through his service as a chairman and chief executive officer of a large international public company, along with extensive financial expertise and brand marketing experience. Through his experiences at biotechnology and pharmaceutical companies, he also brings significant expertise in the health sector and technology and innovation. Career Highlights Dr. Levinson, 75, has served as the Chief Executive Officer of Calico, a company focused on health, aging, and well-being, since September 2013. Dr. Levinson previously served as Chief Executive Officer of Genentech, Inc., a medical drug developer, from July 1995 to April 2009, and served as Genentech's Chairman from September 1999 to September 2014. Dr. Levinson also serves on the Board of Directors of the Broad Institute of MIT and Harvard and on the Board of Scientific Consultants at the Memorial Sloan Kettering Cancer Center. Dr. Levinson was awarded the National Medal of Technology and Innovation, the nation's highest honor for achievement and leadership in advancing the fields of science and technology, and the Biotechnology Heritage Award from the Biotechnology Industry Organization and the Chemical Heritage Foundation. Dr. Levinson has been inducted into the Biotech Hall of Fame. Other Public Company Boards: None Tim Cook Chief Executive Officer Director since 2011 Key Skills and Qualifications Tim Cook brings to the Board extensive executive leadership experience in the technology industry, including the management of worldwide operations, sales, service, and support. Career Highlights Mr. Cook, 65, has served as Apple's Chief Executive Officer since 2011, having previously served as Apple's Chief Operating Officer from October 2005. Mr. Cook joined Apple in March 1998 and served as Executive Vice President, Worldwide Sales and Operations from February 2002 to October 2005. From October 2000 to February 2002, Mr. Cook served as Senior Vice President, Worldwide Operations, Sales, Service and Support. From March 1998 to October 2000, Mr. Cook served as Senior Vice President, Worldwide Operations. Mr. Cook serves on the Board of Directors of The National Football Foundation & College Hall of Fame, Inc., the Board of Trustees of Duke University, and on the Leadership Council for the Malala Fund, an international non-profit

organization that advocates for girls' education. Other Public Company Boards: Current: NIKE, Inc.; 2026 Proxy Statement Table of Contents Summary Governance Directors Compensation Proposals Other Information; Wanda Austin; Director since 2024 Audit Committee; Key Skills and Qualifications Wanda Austin brings to the Board executive leadership experience through her service as president and chief executive officer of a large research and development organization, significant expertise in advanced technology and innovation, experience with environment, cybersecurity, and public policy, and a global business perspective from her service

Aerospace Boards. Career Highlights Dr. Austin, 71, is the retired President and Chief Executive Officer of The Aerospace Corporation, a non-profit organization performing objective technical analyses and development, center committed exclusively to the space community. Dr. Austin joined The Aerospace Corporation in 1979, serving as a member of the National Academy of Engineering and is a co-founder of MakingSpace, Inc., a leadership and science, technology, engineering, and mathematics (STEM) consulting firm. Dr. Austin was the Interim President of the University of Southern California from 2018 to 2019 and has served on the American Energy Innovation Council since 2017. Dr. Austin also served on the Defense Policy Board from 2017 to 2019, the President's Council of Advisors on Science and Technology from 2015 to 2017, the Defense Science Board from 2009 to 2017, and the NASA Advisory Council from 2005 to 2007 and 2014 to 2016. Other Public Company Boards: Current: Amgen Inc.; Chevron Corporation Within Last Five Years: Virgin Galactic Holdings, Inc.; Alex Gorsky; Director since 2021 Nominating Committee People and Compensation Committee; Key Skills and Qualifications Alex Gorsky brings to the Board executive leadership experience, as well as brand marketing

expertise and extensive experience in the fields of health and technology through his service as president and chief executive officer of Johnson & Johnson. Mr. Gorsky is the retired Chief Executive Officer and Executive Chairman of Johnson & Johnson, a global health care products company. Mr. Gorsky served as Executive Chairman from January 2022 to December 2023, having previously served as CEO from April 2012 and Chair of the Board from December 2012. Mr. Gorsky joined Johnson & Johnson in 1988, serving in various positions

Mr. Gorsky joined Johnson & Johnson to join Novartis Pharmaceuticals Corporation, where he served as business in North America, before returning to Johnson & Johnson in 2008. Mr. Gorsky is the co-founder of Alderline Group and a General Partner at ICONIQ Capital. Mr. Gorsky serves on the boards of the Travis Manion Foundation, a non-profit organization that empowers veterans to develop character in future generations, and The Cleveland Clinic. Mr. Gorsky also serves on the Board of Advisors at the Wharton School. Mr. Gorsky is the recipient of the Robert F. Kennedy Human Rights Ripple of Hope Award, and the Prix Galien Roy Vagelos Pro Bono Humanum Award. Other Public Company Boards: Current: International Business Machines Corporation; JPMorgan Chase & Co. Within Last Five Years: Johnson & Johnson; Andrea Jung; Director since 2008 Nominating Committee People and Compensation Committee (Chair); Key Skills and Qualifications Andrea Jung brings to the Board executive leadership experience, a global business perspective, and extensive brand marketing and consumer products experience, including through her service as a chair and chief executive officer of a large international public company and her service on other boards. Career Highlights Ms. Jung, 67, has served as the President and Chief Executive Officer and a member of the Board of Grameen America LLC, a non-profit microfinance organization helping women who live in poverty build small businesses, since April 2014. Ms. Jung previously served as Executive Chairman of Avon Products, Inc., a personal care products company, from April 2012 to December 2012, and as Chairman of the Board of Avon from September 2001 to April 2012. Ms. Jung served as Chief Executive Officer of Avon from November 1999 to April 2012, and served as a member of Avon's Board from January 1998 to December 2012. Ms. Jung also serves on the Board of Rockefeller Capital Management. Other Public Company Boards: Current: Wayfair Inc. Within Last Five Years: Unilever PLC; Monica Lozano; Director since 2021 Audit Committee; Key Skills and Qualifications Monica Lozano brings to the Board executive leadership experience, and experience in operations, strategic planning, media and marketing, including through her service as a board chair and chief executive officer, and a global business perspective from her service on other boards. Career Highlights Ms. Lozano, 69, is the retired President and Chief Executive Officer of the College Futures Foundation, a charitable foundation working to increase the rate of college graduation for low-income California students. Ms. Lozano served in this role from December 2017 to August 2022. Ms. Lozano also co-founded The Aspen Institute Latinos and Society Program and served as Chair of its Advisory Board from January 2015 to October 2019. Her career in media spanned more than 30 years, including as Chair of the Board of Directors of U.S. Hispanic Media, Inc., the parent company of ImpreMedia, a national Hispanic news and information company, from June 2014 to January 2016, and as Chair of ImpreMedia from July 2012 to January 2016 and Chief Executive Officer from May

2010 to May 2014. She also served as Publisher of La Opinión from 2004 to May 2014 and Chief Executive Officer from 2004 to July 2012. Ms. Lozano serves on the Board of the Weingart Foundation, a private grantmaking foundation advancing racial, social, and economic justice in Southern California, and is a Member of the American Academy of Arts and Sciences. Other Public Company Boards: Current: Bank of America Corporation; Target Corporation 2026 Proxy Statement 29 Table of Contents Summary Governance Directors Compensation Proposals Other Information Ron Sugar Director since 2010 Audit Committee (Chair) Key Skills and Qualifications Ron Sugar brings to the Board executive leadership experience as a chairman and chief executive officer of a large international public company, financial expertise as a former chief financial officer, experience in worldwide operations, understanding of advanced technology, experience with government relations and public policy, and a global business perspective from his tenure at global companies and his service on other boards. Career Highlights Dr. Sugar, 77, is the retired Chairman and Chief Executive Officer of Northrop Grumman Corporation, a global security company. Dr. Sugar served in this role from April 2003 to June 2010 and served as President and Chief Operating Officer from 2001 to 2003. Before joining Northrop Grumman, he held executive positions at Litton Industries and TRW Inc., where he served as Chief Financial Officer. Dr. Sugar serves on the Board of Trustees of the University of Southern California and on the Board of the Los Angeles Philharmonic Association. Dr. Sugar was elected as a member of the National Academy of Engineering for major contributions to advanced space communication systems and leadership in aerospace innovation. Other Public Company Boards: Current: Uber Technologies, Inc. Within Last Five Years: Amgen Inc.; Chevron Corporation Sue Wagner Director since 2014 Audit Committee Nominating Committee (Chair) Key Skills and Qualifications Sue Wagner brings to the Board operational experience and a global business perspective, including through her service as chief operating officer of a large multinational public company, as well as her service on other boards. Ms. Wagner also brings extensive financial expertise and experience in the highly regulated financial services industry. Career Highlights Ms. Wagner, 64, is a co-founder of BlackRock, Inc., an asset management company. Ms. Wagner served as BlackRock’s Vice Chair from January 2006 until her retirement in July 2012, and also served as a member of BlackRock’s Global Executive Committee and Global Operating Committee. During her tenure at BlackRock, Ms. Wagner served as BlackRock’s Chief Operating Officer and Head of Corporate Strategy, and led the alternative investments and international client businesses. Ms. Wagner also serves on the Board of Directors of Color Health, Inc., a privately held health technology company. Other Public Company Boards: Current: BlackRock, Inc.; Samsara Inc. Within Last Five Years: Swiss Re Ltd. 30 2026 Proxy Statement Table of Contents Summary Governance Directors Compensation Proposals Other Information Compensation of Directors Members of the Board who are not Apple employees

(2018220;Non-Employee Directors the Board, as an Apple employee, Mr. Cook, our CEO, serves on the Board. The People and Compensation Committee annually reviews the total Non-Employee Directors and each element of our Non-Employee Director compensation program. As part of this process, the People and Compensation Committee evaluates market data provided by its independent compensation consultant, Pay Governance

determine仔pay recommendations–Employee’s a recommendation to the Board. The Board Committee’s recommendation. The Apple and Non-Employee

Director’s Plan (the 20120;D’s for million for all compensation paid or granted

service’Employer’s Cash Retainers Our Non-Employee Directors receive an annual

\$100,000. In 2025, the Chair of the Board, Dr. Levinson, received an additional cash retainer of \$175,000; the

Chair Committee, Dr. Sugar, received an additional cash retainer of \$45,000; the Chair of the People and Compensation

Committee, Ms. Wagner, received an additional cash retainer of \$40,000; and the Chair of the Nominating

 Equity-Based Awards \$35,000. A substantial portion of each Non-Employee Director’s

the form of equity awards. Under the Director Plan, Non-Employee Directors are granted restricted stock units

(2018220;2021)–Annual the date of each annual meeting of shareholders (each, an “Annual Director

Board through the vesting date, 1 of the following year, subject to continued service on the

2020,000. Dr. Dr. Levinson’s request the Annual Director Award value to

Exceptional’Dr. Levinson, the Director of AS’s \$275,000 With the

in 2025 was 125,000. Awards determined by dividing \$350,000 by the per

share of the grant date Apple’s nearest whole share. Dr. Levinson’s Annual

determined by dividing \$275,000 by the per share closing price of Apple’s common stock on the grant date,

to be connected with whole share meeting of shareholders will receive a grant of RSU's upon appointment for the Board other

“Initial Director Award”), except that a Non-Employee Director who first joins the Board on or after

~~immediately prior to~~ immediately prior to the annual meeting for that year, or a director who was an employee of Apple
RSUs subject to each Initial Director Award, will not receive an Initial Director Award. The number of
~~Dwards, but the award is pro-rated based~~ Awards, but the award is pro-rated based manner as described above for Annual Director
~~meeting initial Directors whose terms have expired since the last annual~~ meeting initial Directors whose terms have expired since the last annual
~~on the next meeting of the Board through the following dates: 8/16/07 to~~ on the next meeting of the Board through the following dates: 8/16/07 to
~~is credited with an amount equal to any ordinary dividend paid by Apple, multiplied by the total number of RSUs subject to~~ is credited with an amount equal to any ordinary dividend paid by Apple, multiplied by the total number of RSUs subject to
the

protocol introduced. Non-Employee Director is eligible to receive, upon request and free of charge, one of each new
by Apple Inc. eligible to participate purchase additional equipment at a discount. Each Non-Employee Director
2022 Apple Inc. 2017-2018 Statement of Compensation Summary App Coverage Directors Compensation Proposals
Other Information Deferred Compensation Plan We maintain the Apple Inc. Deferred Compensation
Plan “Deferred Compensation Plan ”), under which eligible participants, including our Non-Employee
Directors, may

Expected within five years after joining the Board, each Non-Employee Director is retained jointly with or separately. Shares individually owned directly by the individual, individually or jointly with or separately for the individual and his or her children.

[illegible]

 445,373 (1) In accordance with SEC rules, the amounts shown reflect the aggregate grant date fair value of RSUs granted to Non-Employee Directors during 2025, computed in accordance with Financial Accounting Standards Board Accounting Standards Codification Topic 718 (FASB ASC 718). The grant date fair value for RSUs is measured based on the closing price of Apple's common stock on the date of grant. Each Non-Employee Director serving on the Board on February 25, 2025, received an Annual Director Award with a grant date fair value for each RSU of \$247.04. Dr. Levinson received an Annual Director Award of 1,113 RSUs and each other Non-Employee Director received an Annual Director Award of 1,355 RSUs. As of September 27, 2025, Dr. Levinson held 1,113

Table of Contents 2020-2021, Governance, Directors Compensation Proposals Other Information

Kate Adams Senior Vice President, General Counsel and Secretary Ms. Adams, 61, oversees all of Apple’s legal matters, including corporate governance, intellectual property, litigation, compliance, global security, and privacy. Kate joined Apple as General Counsel in November 2017. Prior to joining Apple, Kate served as General Counsel of Honeywell International Inc., a diversified technology and manufacturing company, from September 2008. Prior to joining Honeywell in 2003, Kate was a partner at the law firm of Sidley Austin LLP. Sabih Khan Chief Operating Officer Mr. Khan, 59, oversees Apple’s entire worldwide operations, environmental and social initiatives, as well as AppleCare customer service and support. Sabih leads the team in charge of Apple’s global supply chain, ensuring product quality, and overseeing planning, procurement, manufacturing, logistics, and product fulfillment functions, as well as Apple’s supply chain innovation programs that protect and educate workers at supplier facilities around the world. Sabih also oversees teams focused on Apple’s environmental and social initiatives, accessibility and artificial intelligence data operations. As the leader of AppleCare, Sabih also leads the dedicated teams that help customers navigate any service and support they need for all of their Apple products and services. Sabih joined Apple in August 1995 and assumed his current position in July 2025. Sabih’s previous positions at Apple include Senior Vice President, Operations and Vice President, Product Operations. Prior to joining Apple, Sabih worked at GE Plastics. Deirdre O’Brien Senior Vice President, Retail People Deirdre O’Brien, 50, oversees Apple’s retail stores and online teams, and Apple’s People team. As the leader of Apple’s retail and online teams, Deirdre supports their work to enrich the lives of millions of Apple customers every year. In her role as the leader of the People team, Deirdre is dedicated to helping everyone at Apple do the best work of their lives, build on the Company’s special culture, and achieve their full potential. Deirdre joined Apple in July 1988 and assumed her current position in October 2024, having previously served in the role from February 2019 to May 2023. Deirdre’s previous positions with Apple include Senior Vice President, Retail; Vice President, People; and Vice President, Operations. Kevan Parekh Senior Vice President, Financial Planning and Analysis Kevan Parekh, 54, oversees Apple’s tax, accounting, and business support. He joined Apple in June 2013 and assumed his current position in January 2025. Kevan’s previous positions at Apple include Vice President, Financial Planning and Analysis and Vice President, Worldwide Finance for Sales, Marketing, and Retail. Prior to joining Apple, Kevan held various senior leadership roles at Thomson Reuters and General Motors. 34 2026 Proxy Statement Table of Contents Summary Governance Directors Compensation Proposals Other Information Executive Compensation Discussion and Analysis and People’s Compensation Committee Report 51 Executive Compensation Tables 52 2026 Proxy Statement 35 Table of Contents Summary Governance Directors Compensation Proposals Other Information Andrea Jung (Chair) Alex Gorsky Art Levinson Message from the Compensation Committee Dear Fellow Shareholders, On behalf of the Board of Directors, thank you for your investment in Apple, and for your support of its leadership, its people, and its mission of enriching lives through its products and services. Apple is constantly raising the bar on excellence in innovation, and our leaders continue to deliver outstanding results. For our part, the People and Compensation Committee remains focused on supporting Apple’s world class leadership team and Compensation Committee’s intent is to reinforce Apple’s executive compensation program, built to reward leaders for their strong performance and acumen navigating an ever-changing business environment. That includes Apple’s Chief Executive Officer, Tim Cook, whose remarkable leadership has been instrumental in Apple’s track record of success and unmatched innovation on behalf of its users. As a committee, we’re charged with ensuring that the compensation of Apple’s CEO reflects this exceptional record. As we’ve previously communicated, we intend to set Tim’s compensation between the 80th and 90th percentiles of target CEO pay at Apple’s peer companies relative to the company’s size, scope, and success, and his 2025 compensation once again falls within this targeted range. Our shareholders have overwhelmingly approved of this approach, as demonstrated by the support for Apple’s Say on Pay proposal at the 2025 Annual Meeting. As always, we value shareholder feedback, and we appreciate the continued shareholder support of Apple and its vital work of empowering people through technology and, in doing so, enriching their lives. Sincerely, Andrea Jung Alex Gorsky Art Levinson 2026 Proxy Statement 37 Table of Contents Summary Governance Directors Compensation Proposals Other Information Compensation Discussion and Analysis This Compensation Discussion and Analysis (“CD&A”) explains the principles and practices upon which our executive compensation program operates, and the 2025 Name’s Exceptional Compensation Office’s 2025 Summary of

\$416.2

billion with growth in iPhone, Mac, iPad, and Services, and all-time records in the vast majority of markets we track. Guided

[illegible]

Saraj Executive Officer & #160; Counsel and Secretary & #160; Sabih Khan
Spencer Vice President & #160; Maestri

Spring 2014 President: Kate Adams

2023 Effect of the People's Republic of China Tax on Compensation paid to our named executive officers in strong financial results Apple's success and continues to demonstrate alignment with Apple's compensation is at risk and delivers The vast majority of our named executive officers' performance-based RSUs awarded in 2025 reflect Apple's from the start of 2022 through the period 2024. Apple's total shareholder return relative to the S&P 500 (relative TSR) was at the 81.20th percentile for this performance period as a result of 2025 with performance-based RSUs granted in 2022 vested in 187% of the target

Apple Inc. 2025 Sales Projections. We also reported net sales of \$416.2 billion and operating income results of \$133.1 billion for 2025. Cash incentive plan for the 8/8/2020 Cash incentive plan for executive officers under the Apple Inc. Executive

At the 2625 and #82 Meeting 6928 & #160, a cast Pay the Sayon Pay Advisor & #160;

proposition program, demonstrating significant shareholder support for the overall structure of the compensation program and the compensation paid to our named executive officers for 2024. The People and Compensation

[illegible]

As highlighted in the following table.

pledging, and Apple securities. We have robust stock ownership guidelines for our named executive officers, including a ten times annual base salary requirement for our CEO. Compensation recoupment policies We have a policy for the recovery of any erroneously awarded performance-based incentive compensation, as required under Section 10D-1 of the Exchange Act and Nasdaq listing standards. In addition, we maintain a discretionary recoupment policy applicable to our named executive officers and our broader executive team that allows for recovery of annual cash incentives, time and performance-based equity awards, or other amounts that may be paid with respect to awards in certain events, including for certain acts of misconduct by our named executive officers. No repricing We do not allow repricing of stock options without shareholder approval. Limited perquisites We provide limited perquisites to our named executive officers. For example, for security and efficiency purposes, Mr. Cook is provided personal security protection and is required by the Board to use private aircraft for all business and personal travel. No tax gross-ups on perquisites We do not provide tax gross-ups for the limited perquisites provided to our named executive officers. No change of control payments We do not provide change of control payments or gross-ups of related excise taxes. Vesting requirements for dividend equivalents Dividend equivalents will not be paid unless and until the vesting and performance conditions for the underlying equity award are met. At-will employment Our named executive officers do not have employment contracts and are employed at will. No pension or other supplemental benefits We do not provide pension, supplemental executive health, or insurance benefits. Annual compensation risk assessment The People and Compensation Committee oversees an annual risk assessment of our compensation program. Independent compensation consultant The People and Compensation Committee directly retains an independent compensation consultant that performs no services for Apple other than services for the People and Compensation Committee. 2026 Proxy Statement 39 Table of Contents Summary Governance Directors

Compensation Proposals Other Information; Guiding Compensation Principles; Our executive compensation program is designed to motivate and reward outstanding leaders and promote team-wide success. Our compensation policies and practices align the pay of our named executive officers with the size, scope, and success of Apple's business. Team-Based Approach; We apply a unique team-based approach to the compensation of our named executive officers. This approach recognizes the exceptional experience, expertise, and leadership that our named executive officers contribute to Apple's leadership team, and is designed to reflect the additional scope and complexity of that role. Performance Expectations; The vast majority of our executive pay is tied to Apple's financial performance and the long-term interests of shareholders. Each year, we establish clear, quantitative financial goals for our named executive officers that are intended to drive Apple's overall success. Emphasis on Long-Term Equity Awards; We emphasize long-term performance, retention, and alignment between the interests of our named executive officers and those of our shareholders by allocating a significant portion of our named executive compensation to long-term equity awards. Performance-based RSUs reward long-term TSR out-performance relative to peer companies, and the long-term RSUs are also an important component of long-term equity awards because they align our named executive officers' interests with those of our shareholders. People and Compensation Committee Considerations When Setting Compensation; We consider a number of factors when setting compensation, including: Retaining exceptional, values-driven leaders; Considering shareholder interests and feedback; Maintaining Apple's unique team-based approach; Executive Compensation Decision-Making Process; Establishing appropriate compensation and incentive opportunities.

People and Compensation Committee The People and Compensation Committee is a committee of the Board of Directors of Apple Inc. (the "Board") that reviews and approves the compensation and incentives of Apple's named executive officers. The People and Compensation Committee may also administer Apple's employee stock plans. The People and Compensation Committee may delegate its authority to any of its members, except to the extent prohibited by SEC or Nasdaq rules, or other applicable laws. The People and Compensation Committee's authority is limited to the administration of Apple's employee stock plans or to take any other action with respect to the compensation of Apple's named executive officers.

Compensation Consultant The People and Compensation Committee has retained a compensation consultant to assist it in its duties. The People and Compensation Committee selects and retains the services of a compensation consultant as part of its annual review of the compensation of its named executive officers. The People and Compensation Committee considers SEC and Nasdaq rules. During 2025, the People and Compensation Committee's independent compensation consultant was PwC. The People and Compensation Committee may also retain other advisors, including a compensation consultant, to assist it in its duties. The People and Compensation Committee may also retain other advisors, including a compensation consultant, to assist it in its duties. The People and Compensation Committee may also retain other advisors, including a compensation consultant, to assist it in its duties.

Pay Governance The People and Compensation Committee has established a Pay Governance Committee, which is responsible for overseeing the compensation of Apple's named executive officers. The Pay Governance Committee is composed of members of the People and Compensation Committee and other members of the Board. The Pay Governance Committee is responsible for reviewing and approving the compensation of Apple's named executive officers, including the setting of target compensation levels, the design of compensation programs, and the review of compensation programs. The Pay Governance Committee also oversees the compensation of Apple's non-executive directors. The Pay Governance Committee is responsible for reviewing and approving the compensation of Apple's named executive officers, including the setting of target compensation levels, the design of compensation programs, and the review of compensation programs. The Pay Governance Committee also oversees the compensation of Apple's non-executive directors.

Compensation Committee's Role The People and Compensation Committee is responsible for reviewing and approving the compensation of Apple's named executive officers. The People and Compensation Committee is also responsible for reviewing and approving the compensation of Apple's non-executive directors. The People and Compensation Committee is responsible for reviewing and approving the compensation of Apple's named executive officers, including the setting of target compensation levels, the design of compensation programs, and the review of compensation programs. The People and Compensation Committee is also responsible for reviewing and approving the compensation of Apple's non-executive directors.

Compensation Committee's Composition The People and Compensation Committee is composed of members of the Board of Directors of Apple Inc. The People and Compensation Committee is responsible for reviewing and approving the compensation of Apple's named executive officers, including the setting of target compensation levels, the design of compensation programs, and the review of compensation programs. The People and Compensation Committee is also responsible for reviewing and approving the compensation of Apple's non-executive directors.

Compensation Committee's Responsibilities The People and Compensation Committee is responsible for reviewing and approving the compensation of Apple's named executive officers, including the setting of target compensation levels, the design of compensation programs, and the review of compensation programs. The People and Compensation Committee is also responsible for reviewing and approving the compensation of Apple's non-executive directors.

Compensation Committee's Authority The People and Compensation Committee is authorized to review and approve the compensation of Apple's named executive officers, including the setting of target compensation levels, the design of compensation programs, and the review of compensation programs. The People and Compensation Committee is also authorized to review and approve the compensation of Apple's non-executive directors.

Compensation Committee's Reporting The People and Compensation Committee is required to report to the Board of Directors of Apple Inc. on its activities and the compensation of Apple's named executive officers. The People and Compensation Committee is also required to report to the Board of Directors of Apple Inc. on the compensation of Apple's non-executive directors.

Compensation Committee's Compensation The People and Compensation Committee is not compensated for its services. The People and Compensation Committee is also not compensated for its services.

Compensation Committee's Term The People and Compensation Committee is composed of members of the Board of Directors of Apple Inc. The People and Compensation Committee is responsible for reviewing and approving the compensation of Apple's named executive officers, including the setting of target compensation levels, the design of compensation programs, and the review of compensation programs. The People and Compensation Committee is also responsible for reviewing and approving the compensation of Apple's non-executive directors.

Compensation Committee's Success The People and Compensation Committee is responsible for reviewing and approving the compensation of Apple's named executive officers, including the setting of target compensation levels, the design of compensation programs, and the review of compensation programs. The People and Compensation Committee is also responsible for reviewing and approving the compensation of Apple's non-executive directors.

Compensation Committee's Challenges The People and Compensation Committee is responsible for reviewing and approving the compensation of Apple's named executive officers, including the setting of target compensation levels, the design of compensation programs, and the review of compensation programs. The People and Compensation Committee is also responsible for reviewing and approving the compensation of Apple's non-executive directors.

Compensation Committee's Future The People and Compensation Committee is responsible for reviewing and approving the compensation of Apple's named executive officers, including the setting of target compensation levels, the design of compensation programs, and the review of compensation programs. The People and Compensation Committee is also responsible for reviewing and approving the compensation of Apple's non-executive directors.

People and Compensation Committee's

Apple's website and to expect People and Compensation Committee

reviewed our 2024 annualized target CEO pay of our primary peer group, focusing particularly on 90th CEO pay when setting Mr. Cook's pay. Other than for Mr. Cook, the People and Compensation

Committee's compensation components for our named executive officers to meet specific

performance goals. The 2025 Compensation Committee's Other Information; The threshold revenue and market capitalization requirements for

Apple's primary peer group for 2025 were \$20 billion and \$100

primary peer group for 2025 primary peer group. Apple, Microsoft, Mastercard, NVIDIA, Verizon, Amazon, Comcast, Meta, Oracle, Visa, AT&T, Disney, Microsoft, Qualcomm, Warner Bros. Discovery, Broadcom, Intel, Netflix, Salesforce, and others. For many years, a secondary peer group of companies was developed as an additional reference set to assess pay practices but

companies that have lower levels of research and development and

innovation for growth and are highly significant research and development and

skilled employees. For 2025, this group included AbbVie, Coca-Cola, Johnson &

considered from limited data. In 2025, while points of reference may be

and compensation peer group for 2026. The People and Compensation

Committee's compensation components for our named executive officers to meet specific

performance goals. The 2025 Compensation Committee's Other Information; The threshold revenue and market capitalization requirements for

Apple's primary peer group for 2025 were \$20 billion and \$100

primary peer group for 2025 primary peer group. Apple, Microsoft, Mastercard, NVIDIA, Verizon, Amazon, Comcast, Meta, Oracle, Visa, AT&T, Disney, Microsoft, Qualcomm, Warner Bros. Discovery, Broadcom, Intel, Netflix, Salesforce, and others. For many years, a secondary peer group of companies was developed as an additional reference set to assess pay practices but

companies that have lower levels of research and development and innovation for growth and are highly significant research and development and skilled employees. For 2025, this group included AbbVie, Coca-Cola, Johnson & considered from limited data. In 2025, while points of reference may be and compensation peer group for 2026. The People and Compensation Committee's compensation components for our named executive officers to meet specific performance goals. The 2025 Compensation Committee's Other Information; The threshold revenue and market capitalization requirements for

Apple's primary peer group for 2025 were \$20 billion and \$100

primary peer group for 2025 primary peer group. Apple, Microsoft, Mastercard, NVIDIA, Verizon, Amazon, Comcast, Meta, Oracle, Visa, AT&T, Disney, Microsoft, Qualcomm, Warner Bros. Discovery, Broadcom, Intel, Netflix, Salesforce, and others. For many years, a secondary peer group of companies was developed as an additional reference set to assess pay practices but

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companies that have lower levels of research and development and innovation for growth and are highly significant research and development and

skilled employees. For 2025, this group included AbbVie, Coca-Cola, Johnson &

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performance goals. The 2025 Compensation Committee's Other Information; The threshold revenue and market capitalization requirements for

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companies that have lower levels of research and development and innovation for growth and are highly significant research and development and

skilled employees. For 2025, this group included AbbVie, Coca-Cola, Johnson &

considered from limited data. In 2025, while points of reference may be

and compensation peer group for 2026. The People and Compensation

Committee's compensation components for our named executive officers to meet specific

performance goals. The 2025 Compensation Committee's Other Information; The threshold revenue and market capitalization requirements for

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companies that have lower levels of research and development and

innovation for growth and are highly significant research and development and

skilled employees. For 2025, this group included AbbVie, Coca-Cola, Johnson &

considered from limited data. In 2025, while points of reference may be

and compensation peer group for 2026. The People and Compensation

Committee's compensation components for our named executive officers to meet specific

performance goals. The 2025 Compensation Committee's Other Information; The threshold revenue and market capitalization requirements for

regarding the Cash Incentive Plan for 2025 can be found below in the section entitled “Cash Incentive Plan”;

“Long-Term Equity Awards”; Long-Term Equity Awards with vesting principles, the vast majority of our named executive officers’ total target compensation is made up of long-term equity incentives that emphasize long-term shareholder value creation and the executive leadership team through a mix of performance-based and time-based RSU awards. Additional details regarding these awards can be found below in the section entitled “2025 Long-Term Equity Awards and Results”; RSU awards with time-based vesting align the interests of our named executive officers, promoting the stability and retention of a high-performing executive team. The time-based vesting schedules for the long-term equity awards granted to our named executive officers are generally longer than peer companies and in the broader industry. RSU awards with performance-based vesting are a substantial, at-risk

performance of the named executive officers. Compensation tied to Apple’s long-term performance is reported in the People and Compensation Committee’s for the year ended December 31, 2024, as a measure of performance. The performance of our named executive officers with the interests of our shareholders in creating long-term value for Apple. Statement 43 Table of Contents Summary Governance Directors Compensation Proposals Other Information; Summary of CEO Total Target Compensation; The People and Compensation Committee evaluates our executive compensation

program and the stated objectives of Mr. Cook’s compensation. The People and Compensation Committee considered for 2025 factors with the following including Mr. Cook’s consistently outstanding leadership, the immense scope of Apple’s business, the Board’s confidence in his long-term strategic decisions, the

Company’s financial results, and shareholder feedback. Balancing the size, scope, and success of Apple group, Mr. Cook’s creation of a meaningful relative to the CEOs in our primary peer group, the committee set Mr. Cook’s 2025 target compensation at \$59 million, which is 30% higher than his 2024 total target compensation as shown below. 2025 Total Target CEO Compensation: \$59 million; Base Salary: \$3 million. Mr. Cook’s base salary has remained the same since 2016; Target Cash Incentive Plan Opportunity: \$6 million. Mr. Cook’s target Cash Incentive Plan opportunity for 2025 remained at 200% of his base salary; Target Equity Award Value: \$50 million. Award Mix: 25/75. Mr. Cook was granted an equity award with 25% subject to time-based vesting and 75% subject to performance-based vesting. No changes were made to the amount of Mr. Cook’s base salary or annual cash incentive payout opportunity for 2025. The committee also maintained the total target value of Mr. Cook’s equity award for 2025 at \$50 million (2024: \$50 million). The 2025 Equity Award value and structure is unchanged from the equity award he received in 2024, with 75% of the award granted in the form of performance-based RSUs. This structure continues to emphasize long-term

shareholder growth and alignment while recognizing the growth and success Mr. Cook has continually delivered since his tenure. Equity awards granted to Mr. Cook align with Apple’s long-term performance strategy and creating meaningful incentives aligned with the long-term interests of our shareholders. During the vast majority of Mr. Cook’s compensation has been delivered through long-term equity awards. The size

value delivered to Mr. Cook has been granted aligns with Apple’s growth, success, and the tremendous success of Apple’s leadership. Since Mr. Cook was promoted to CEO in 2011 and through the Apple’s stock price appreciation of 2,162%, significantly outpacing the S&P 500, and reinvested \$1.1 billion. Cumulative TSR, includes data and is considered. The People and Compensation Committee performed a comprehensive review of Mr. Cook’s total target

mark of Mr. Cook’s executive compensation program for 2026 and made no changes to the amount or structure of the program. Summary Governance Directors Compensation 2025 Table of Contents Summary of Other Named Executive Officer Total Target Compensation; The total target compensation of our five other named executive officers, Kevan Parekh, Kate Adams, Sabih Khan, Luca Maestri, and others of the executive compensation program is straightforward and effective way. Taking into account individual and Company performance, as well as and shareholder feedback, which has consistently confirmed support for the amount of compensation, the People and Compensation Committee

[illegible]

achievement for a named executive officer to receive an annual cash incentive payout. The target goal is being governed by the fact that, while challenging to achieve based on the considerations noted above, would also represent financial performance on an underlying basis commensurate with the target payout opportunity. The maximum goals

2025 Financial Performance Results For 2025, we reported net sales of \$416.2 billion and operating income of \$13.9 billion, representing a year-over-year increase of six percent (\$25.2 billion) and

of \$13.9 billion, representing a year-over-year increase of six percent (\$25.2 billion) and

These achievements exceeded our expectations for the year and resulted in a

performance that the People and Compensation Committee

approved goals as well as the alternate scenarios considered at the time the goals were

set. In 2025, we achieved an all-time revenue record of \$416.2 billion, with growth in iPhone, Mac, iPad, and

services and in the vast majority of markets we track. These results reflect the tremendous customer enthusiasm

for Apple products and services, as well as our deep commitment to innovation. The net sales and operating income results

supported the enhanced maximum financial goals considered, resulting in a maximum payout

Executive Officer Plan payments to the People and Compensation Committee awarded maximum

Table of Contents Summary Governance Directors Compensation Proposals Other Information 2025 Long-Term

Equity Awards and Results When setting the value of equity awards for our named executive officers, the People and Compensation Committee considers

the named executive officer's relative performance compared to peer companies and the scope of

equity awards. In September 2024, we granted 50% performance-based long-term

granted a time-based RSU award to our named executive officer, Vice President, Corporate

Secretary, Tim Cook, on September 29, 2024 of 75% performance-based and 25% time-based

RSUs granted in 2025 were granted under, and subject to, the terms of the Apple Inc. 2022 Employee Stock

(2022 Plan) and 2025 Performance-Based RSUs. The People and Compensation Committee continued to use Relative TSR

as the performance metric for RSUs granted during 2025, with the S&P 500 as the

performance of other large companies and aligns our performance against the

shareholders' interests. Long-term incentive compensation for our named executive officers is a substantial, at-risk component of our

performance-based compensation tied to Apple's long-term performance. The number of

RSUs that vest depends on performance relative to the applicable performance period. To

RSUs, we use the S&P 500 and the Relative TSR based on the change in each company's

that period, which are applicable performance period, taking into account any dividends paid during

beginning and ending the stock price trading averaging period is used to determine the

in the S&P 500. The total trading volume of Apple and the other companies

period and the impact of the stock price relative to the S&P 500. The results of

price of the other companies in the period. The end of the period is divided by the

beginning of the period. The value of the performance-based RSUs granted on September 29, 2024, have a

period from the beginning of 2025 through the end of 2027. Subject to the terms of the award agreements,

between 20% of the target number of performance-based RSUs will vest on October 1, 2027, depending on Apple's Relative

Compensation Performance-Based RSUs vesting period, as follows: Target 25th Percentile 50th Percentile 75th Percentile 100th Percentile

55th Percentile 100% 25th Percentile 25% Below 25th 0% If Apple's TSR for the performance period is negative, the

regardless of our Relative TSR, the vesting will be capped at 100% of the target,

proportionally interpolated between the RSUs nearest vesting percentages. 2026 Proxy Statement 47

Table of Contents Summary Governance Directors Compensation Proposals Other Information The target number

of performance-based RSUs granted to our named

performance officer was determined by the closing stock price on the date of

RSUs for each named executive officer as follows: Named Executive Officer Target Performance-Based

RSU Value Tim Cook \$37,500,000 Kevan Parekh \$8,375,000 Kate Adams \$10,000,000 Sabih Khan \$10,000,000 Luca

Maestri \$2,500,000 Deirdre O'Brien \$10,000,000 The grant date fair values of these RSUs are reported in the

2025 Summary

Compensation Table 2025, 2024, and 2023. Performance-Based RSU

[illegible]

time-based RSU vesting in the event of death or disability. The time-based and performance-based RSU agreements for Mr. Cook

same terms. (5) This amount represents (i) Apple's contributions to Mr. Parekh's account under the 401(k) plan in the amount of \$21,000; and (ii) term life insurance premiums paid by Apple in the amount of \$1,338. (6) This amount represents: (i) Apple's contributions to Ms. Adams' account under the 401(k) plan in the amount of \$21,000; and (ii) term life insurance premiums paid by Apple in the amount of \$1,482. (7) This amount represents: (i) Apple's contributions to Mr. Khan's account under the 401(k) plan in the amount of \$20,423; and (ii) term life insurance premiums paid by Apple in the amount of \$1,482. (8) This amount represents: (i) Apple's contributions to Mr. Maestri's account under the 401(k) plan in the amount of \$21,000; and (ii) term life insurance premiums paid by Apple in the amount of \$1,204. (9) This amount represents: (i) Apple's contributions to Ms. O'Brien's account under the 401(k) plan in the

plan compensation for each fiscal year from 2023 to 2025 based on the ordinary Compensation Table for 2025, 2024, and 2023, respectively, and the value of the award is determined as the value of the award at the date of grant.

Award #8212;2025/8222, Outstanding Equity VestedÔ2025Ý provide further information

on the officers' and directors' potential realizable value and actual value realized with respect to their equity awards. The following table summarizes the information required by the rules:

Compensation Discussion 2021 and 2025, 2024, and the 2023-2025; should be read in conjunction with the

202684160, Proposal 160 Statement of Contents Summary Governance Directors Compensation Proposals

Other Information; Grants of Plan-Based Awards; The following table shows information regarding

The 160 are #160; Vesting Grant Future Payments Under New Officers for 2025; Plan 60; and 60# 160; \$ Payouts Under Equity Incentive Plan Awards All Other Stock Awards: Number of Shares of Stock or Units (#) Grant

Other Equity Incentive Plans	Awards	Number of Shares of Stock or Units	Date	Fair Value of Stock Awards (1) (\$)	Name	Award Type	Grant Date	Threshold (\$)
------------------------------	--------	------------------------------------	------	-------------------------------------	------	------------	------------	----------------

##160:##160:##160:##160:##160: Target (\$) ##160:##160:##160:##160:##160: Maximum (\$)

Threshold (#) Target (#)

 Threshold (#)
 Maximum (#)

[illegible]

6,000,000 12,000,000 — — — — — —

Performance- based RSUs 09/29/2024 41,157

164,626 329,252 — 45,035,089 Time-based RSUs 09/29/2024

[illegible]

12,500,204 Kevan Parekh Cash Incentive — 780,079 1,560,158

3,120,317 — — — — —

Performance-based RSUs 09/29/2024 — — — 9,192

36,767 73,534 — 10,057,981 Time-based RSUs 09/29/2024

— — — — — — 36,767

8,375,155 Kate Adams Cash Incentive — 1,000,000 2,000,000

4,000,000 — — — — — Performance-

based RSUs 09/29/2024 8212 8212 8212 8212 10,975 43,901 &

87,802 — 12,009,558 Time-based RSUs 09/29/2024 —

43,901 10,000,209 Sabi

Khan Cash Incentive — 1,000,000 2,000,000 4,000,000

Performance-based RSUs

09/29/2024 — — — 10,975 43,901 87,802

— 12,009,558 Time-based RSUs 09/29/2024 — —

— 43,901 10,000,209 Luca Maestri

Cash#160;Incentive #160; #8212; #160; 409,616 #160; 819,231 #160; 1,638,462 #160; #8212; #160;

Performance-based RSUs 09/29/2024

— — — 2,744 10,976 21,952 —

3,002,595 Time-based RSUs 09/29/2024 — — — —

— — — 43,902 10,000,437 Deirdre O’Brien

Cash Incentive — 1,000,000 2,000,000 4,000,000 —

Performance- based RSUs 09/29/2024

— — — 10,975 43,901 87,802 —

12,009,558 Time-based RSUs 09/29/2024 — — —

43,901 10,000,209 (1) The grant date fair value for time-based

RSUs is calculated in accordance with FASB ASC 718 based on the closing price of Apple's common stock on the date of grant. The grant date fair value for performance-based RSUs is calculated using a Monte-Carlo model for each award on the date of grant, determined under FASB ASC 718, incorporating the following assumptions:

- Assumptions
- Grant Date
- Performance Period End Date
- Expected Term (years)
- Expected Volatility
- Risk-Free Interest Rate

09/29/2024 9/25/2027 2.99 27.49% 3.46%

Apple used its historical stock prices as the basis for the volatility assumptions. The rate was based on U.S. Treasury rates in effect at the time of grant. The expected term was based on the remaining time in the performance period on the grant date.

2026 Proxy Statement Table of Contents Summary Governance Directors Compensation Proposals Other Information

Stock Vested 2025

The following table shows information regarding the executive officers, 2025 of Apple's Stock Awards Named

Number of Shares Acquired on Vesting (#)	Value Realized on Vesting (\$)	(1) Tim Cook	695,869	158,898,772	Kevan Parekh	40,152	8,965,991	Kate Adams	201,817	46,039,611	Sabih Khan	201,817	46,039,611	Luca Maestri	205,933	46,873,677	Deirdre O'Brien	201,817	46,039,611
(1) The dollar amounts shown in this column are determined by multiplying the number of shares acquired on vesting by the per-share closing price of Apple's common stock on the vesting date, plus dividend equivalents attributable to such shares in the amount of \$2,146,321 for Mr. Cook, \$613,741 for Mr. Maestri, \$611,683 for each of Ms. Adams, Mr. Khan, and Ms. O'Brien, and \$98,329 for Mr. Parekh.																			

2026 Proxy Statement 55 Table of Contents Summary Governance Directors Compensation Proposals Other Information

Outstanding Equity Awards

The following table shows information regarding the outstanding equity awards

Award Name	Each of the Named Executive Officers	Grant Date	Number of Shares or Units of Stock That Have Not Vested (#)	Market Value of Shares or Units of Stock That Have Not Vested (1) (\$)	Equity Incentive Plan Awards: Number of Unearned Shares, Units or Other Rights That Have Not Vested (#)	Equity Incentive Plan Awards: Market or Payout Value of Unearned Shares, Units or Other Rights That Have Not Vested (1) (\$)
Tim Cook	9/26/2021	85,080	(2)	21,734,537		
	9/25/2022	44,318	(3)	11,321,476	199,429	(4)
	10/01/2023	73,010	(5)	18,651,135	219,030	(5)(6)
	09/29/2024	54,876	(7)	14,018,623	164,626	(6)(7)
Kevan Parekh	9/26/2021	5,530	(8)	1,412,694		
	9/25/2022	17,449	(9)	4,457,522		
	10/01/2023	25,553	(10)	6,527,769		
	09/29/2024	36,767	(7)	9,392,498	36,767	(6)(7)
Kate Adams	9/26/2021	22,688	(11)	5,795,876		
	9/25/2022	44,318	(12)	11,321,476	66,477	(13)
	10/01/2023	58,408	(5)	14,920,908	58,408	(5)(6)
	09/29/2024	43,901	(7)	11,214,949	43,901	(6)(7)
Sabih Khan	9/26/2021	22,688	(11)	5,795,876		
	9/25/2022	44,318	(12)	11,321,476	66,477	(13)
	10/01/2023	58,408	(5)	14,920,908	58,408	(5)(6)
	09/29/2024	43,901	(7)	11,214,949	43,901	(6)(7)
Luca Maestri	9/26/2021	22,688	(11)	5,795,876		
	9/25/2022	44,318	(12)	11,321,476	66,477	(13)
	10/01/2023	58,408	(5)	14,920,908	58,408	(5)(6)
	09/29/2024	43,901	(7)	11,214,949	43,901	(6)(7)
Deirdre O'Brien	9/26/2021	22,688	(11)	5,795,876		
	9/25/2022	44,318	(12)	11,321,476	66,477	(13)
	10/01/2023	58,408	(5)	14,920,908	58,408	(5)(6)
	09/29/2024	43,901	(7)	11,214,949	43,901	(6)(7)

2026 Proxy Statement Table of Contents Summary Governance Directors Compensation Proposals Other Information

(1) The dollar amounts shown in these columns are determined by multiplying the number of shares or units shown in the preceding column by \$255.46, the closing price of Apple's common stock on September 26, 2025, the last trading day of Apple's fiscal year. (2) Subject to the terms of the award agreement, the remaining 85,080 time-based RSUs are

scheduled to be released on April 1, 2026. (3) 22,159 time-based RSUs subject to this award were released on April 1, 2025, and subject to the terms of the award agreement, the remainder of the RSUs are scheduled to be released in two annual installments of 22,159, commencing on April 1, 2026. (4) 139% of the 199,429 target number of performance-based RSUs subject to this award (totalling 277,206 performance-based RSUs)

October 1, 2025, based on Apple's Relative TSR over the relevant performance period. (5) Subject to the terms of the award agreement, the time-based RSUs subject to this award are scheduled to vest and/or be released in three annual installments commencing on April 1, 2026. Subject to the terms of the award agreement, the performance-based RSUs subject to this award are scheduled to vest on October 1, 2026, provided the applicable performance condition is satisfied. (6) The target number of performance-based RSUs is shown. As described under

Executive Compensation Compensation

200% of the target number of performance-based RSUs may vest depending on Apple's Relative TSR over the terms of the award agreement, the time-based RSUs subject to this award are scheduled to vest and/or be released in three annual installments commencing on April 1, 2027. Subject to the terms of the award agreement, the performance-based RSUs subject to this award are scheduled to vest on October 1, 2027, provided the applicable performance condition is satisfied. (8) The remaining 5,530 time-based RSUs subject to this award vested and were released on October 15, 2025. (9) 5,816 time-based RSUs subject to this award vested and were released on October 15, 2025 and subject to the terms of the award

agreed that 5,816 RSUs are scheduled to vest on April 15, 2026 and 5,816 RSUs are scheduled to vest on October 15, 2026. (10) 5,111 time-based RSUs vested and were released on October 15, 2025 and subject to the terms of the award agreement, the remainder of the RSUs are scheduled to vest in four semi-annual installments commencing on April 15, 2026. (11) Subject to the terms of the award agreement, the remaining 22,688 time-based RSUs are scheduled to vest on April 1, 2026. (12) 22,159 time-based RSUs subject to this award vested on April 1, 2025, and subject to the terms of the award agreement, the remainder of the RSUs are scheduled to vest in two annual installments of 22,159, commencing on April 1, 2026. (13) 139% of the 66,477 target number of performance-based RSUs subject to this award (totalling 92,403 performance-based RSUs)

performance period, (2025, based on Apple's Relative TSR released on October 15, 2025 and subject to the terms of the award agreement, the remainder of the RSUs are scheduled to vest in six semi-annual installments commencing on April 15, 2026. Proxy Statement 57 Table of Contents Summary Governance Directors Compensation Proposals Other Information Non-Qualified Deferred Compensation 2025 The following table shows information regarding

Compensation Plan as of September 27, 2025, Deferred Compensation Executive Contributions (\$) Apple Contributions (\$) Aggregate Earnings (\$) Aggregate Withdrawals/ Distributions (\$) Aggregate Balance at September 27, 2025 (\$) Tim Cook 1,624,038 (1) 202,660 2,083,918 (3) Kate Adams 2,400,000 (2) 1,226,962 14,497,897 (3) (1) Reflects \$424,038 of Mr. Cook's base salary for 2025 and \$1,200,000 of Mr. Cook's annual cash incentive payout for 2024

attributed to the Deferred Compensation Plan. These payments are reflected in the Salary Non-Equity Incentive Plan Compensation columns of the Summary Compensation Table 2025, 2024,

and 2023. The portion of Mr. Adams' 2025, the year's cash incentive payout for 2024 deferred (2) and contributed to the Deferred Compensation Plan. The payout is reflected in the Non-Equity Incentive Plan Compensation column of the Summary Compensation Table 2025, 2024, and 2023, under 2024, the year it was earned.

(3) The aggregate balance includes \$1,436,538 for Mr. Cook and \$11,489,225 for Ms. Adams of compensation reported in the Summary

Compensation Table 2025, prior years' office, Description of Non-Qualified Deferred

Deferred Compensation Plan Participants to the Deferred Compensation Plan participants

may elect to defer up to 100% of their eligible cash bonus, or up to

100% of the cash bonus for Non-Employee Directors, by timely completing a deferral election form. Amounts

Deferred Compensation Plan, as adjusted for applicable earnings gains and losses and fees, are credited to the participant's name and remain fully vested at all times. Participants may select at any time from a diversified

and the value of investment options that generally mirror the investment options of Apple's 401(k) plan,

the selected investment Plan account balance may increase or decrease based on the performance

Compensation Plan generally suggest from investment options available for the Deferred

to 60% of the target number of performance-based RSUs subject to this award (totalling 92,403

in service

distribution date. Distributions will be made in a lump sum payment unless the participant elects installment

payments over a

period between the distribution and 10 years. A Deferred Compensation Plan participant also may request to participate in a lump-sum distribution upon termination of employment. If a Deferred Compensation Plan participant elects a lump-sum distribution, the amount will be paid to their beneficiary if the participant dies before receiving a complete distribution.

Payments following termination of employment of Mr. Cook will not have any cash severance arrangements with our named executive officers and none of our named executive officers;

yearly and provide for a right to receive shares in connection with employment for reasons other than death, disability, and, for Mr. Cook, retirement.

Retirement is defined as reaching age 60 and at least 10 years of service

2026 Proxy Statement Table of Contents Summary Governance Directors Compensation Proposals Other Information; Equity Award Treatment Upon Termination of Employment; CEO Awards; Subject to the terms of the award agreements, Mr. Cook's time-based RSUs provide for accelerated vesting in full upon disability. Mr. Cook's 2022 time-based RSUs provide for a continued right to receive the full number of unvested

shares underlying the time-based RSUs upon retirement that occurs on or after the first anniversary of the grant date. Mr. Cook's 2023, 2024, and 2025 time-based RSUs provide for a continued right to receive a pro-rata

of the grant date. The time-based RSUs upon retirement that occurs on or after the first anniversary

vesting period. The elapsed time of Mr. Cook's period of employment during the

shares and shall have. Mr. Cook's RSUs based on accelerated dividend

payments will be subject to the original vesting schedule. If Mr. Cook terminates

employment of the grant date before the first anniversary of the grant date, he will not

have a right to any of the earned but unvested performance-based RSUs.

Reserve shares that are earned based upon full or partial attainment of the award;

termination of employment due to death, disability, or retirement that occurs on or after the first

date of Mr. Cook's grant. If Mr. Cook terminates employment due to retirement before the first anniversary of the grant date

performance-based award, he will not have a right to any of the earned but unvested performance-based RSUs.

Other Named Executive Officer Awards; The time-based RSUs held by our other

to the terms of the award agreements, provide for partial accelerated vesting of the RSUs scheduled

applicable vesting date following a termination of employment due to disability, and for full accelerated

vesting. Performance-based RSUs provide for a partial waiver of the service vesting condition upon the death or

disability

based on actual performance. The number of shares that vest determined at the end of the performance period,

performance period. Based on the estimated Total Value of the hypothetical equity award. The following table shows the estimated

amounts outstanding as of executive officers would have become entitled to under the terms of all equity

executive officers, and retirement terminated due to death or disability for each of our named

for Mr. Cook, based on the last day of Apple's 2025 fiscal year.

RSUs terms of the award agreements. The following table shows the estimated

Estimated Total Value upon Retirement (1) (\$) and Value upon Disability (1) (\$)

Estimated Total Value upon Death (1) (\$) and Value upon Disability (1) (\$)

Estimated Total Value upon Disability (1) (\$) Tim Cook 256,459,589 366,679,154

366,679,154 Kevan Parekh 28,175,626 11,357,950 Kate Adams 105,569,664

105,569,664 73,177,450 Sabih Khan 105,569,664 73,177,450 Luca Maestri

98,940,938 67,449,336 Deirdre O'Brien 105,569,664

73,177,450 (1) The dollar amounts are determined by (i) multiplying the number of RSUs that would have been

subject to accelerated vesting if an officer had retired, died, or become disabled, as applicable, on September 27, 2025,

by \$255.46, the closing price of Apple's common stock on September 26, 2025, the last trading day of the fiscal

year; and (ii) then adding any accumulated dividend equivalents attributable to any such RSUs on that date.

2026 Proxy Statement 59 Table of Contents Summary Governance Directors Compensation Proposals

Other Information; Pay versus Performance; The information below is provided pursuant

to the SEC pay disclosure requirements set forth in Item 402(v) of SEC Regulation S-K (the "Pay

Versus

Performance" rules)

which requires companies to disclose certain information about the relationship

and the company's compensation policy. The following table shows the estimated

Value of Initial Fixed \$100 Investment Based On: Fiscal Year(a); Summary Compensation Table Total for Mr.

Cook(b); Compensation Actually Paid to Mr. Cook(c)

[illegible]

TSR are tightly linked. Relationship Between Compensation Actually Paid and Net Income; Net Income is generally a key indicator of company profitability and, for Apple, can contribute to changes in our stock price, which drives Compensation Actually Paid. There is no direct correlation between Net Income and Compensation Actually Paid.

Program 2021 to 2025 as we do not use Net Income as a financial measure in our executive compensation policy. Relationship Between Compensation Actually Paid and Net Sales; Cash and Net Sales are the financial measure, in addition to Operating Income, that the People and Compensation Committee has set for Sales and Operating Income are equally the most important financial metrics in determining Compensation Actually Paid. Similar to Operating Income, Net Sales were consistently strong from 2021 to 2025, and this sustained performance led to above target or maximum bonus payouts in each of 2021, 2022, 2023, 2024, and 2025, which

Performance Measures. For 2025, the following is a list of the following officers and other relevant financial measures used by Apple to link Compensation Actually Paid with our financial performance: Net Sales; Operating Income; Relative TSR; and 2026 Proxy Statement 61 Table of Contents Summary Governance Directors Compensation Proposals Other Information; CEO Pay Ratio 2025. We offer a wide range of benefits to our

employees and are paid based on their role. We identified a new median employee for 2025. We determined our median compensated employee by using base salary, bonuses, awards granted to employees in 2025 as our consistently applied compensation measure. We applied this measure on September 27, 2025, the last day of our 2025 fiscal year, and included base salaries for those employees who did not work the full year. We calculated the median compensated employee's

2025 compensation using the same methodology that is used to calculate

2024 and 2023 compensation. 2025 compensation was \$139,483, and the ratio

compensation of \$139,483 to the 2025 median employee was \$139,483, and the ratio

compensation of \$139,483 to the 2025 median employee was \$139,483, and the ratio

compensation of \$139,483 to the 2025 median employee was \$139,483, and the ratio

apply compensation, include estimates, and adopt different methodologies that reflect their employee population

2026 Proxy Statement 61 Table of Contents Summary Governance Directors Compensation

Proposals Other Information; Management Proposals; Proposal No. 1; Election of Directors

2026 Proxy Statement 61 Table of Contents Summary Governance Directors Compensation

Proposals Other Information; Management Proposals; Proposal No. 1; Election of Directors

Proposals Other Information; Management Proposals; Proposal No. 1; Election of Directors

Proposals Other Information; Management Proposals; Proposal No. 1; Election of Directors

Proposals Other Information; Management Proposals; Proposal No. 1; Election of Directors

Proposals Other Information; Management Proposals; Proposal No. 1; Election of Directors

Proposals Other Information; Management Proposals; Proposal No. 1; Election of Directors

Proposals Other Information; Management Proposals; Proposal No. 1; Election of Directors

Proposals Other Information; Management Proposals; Proposal No. 1; Election of Directors

Proposals Other Information; Management Proposals; Proposal No. 1; Election of Directors

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Proposals Other Information; Management Proposals; Proposal No. 1; Election of Directors

Proposals Other Information; Management Proposals; Proposal No. 1; Election of Directors

Proposals Other Information; Management Proposals; Proposal No. 1; Election of Directors

Proposals Other Information; Management Proposals; Proposal No. 1; Election of Directors

Proposals Other Information; Management Proposals; Proposal No. 1; Election of Directors

Apple's first independent registered public accounting firm and as auditors of Apple's consolidated financial statements. The Audit Committee reviews the performance of the independent registered public accounting firm annually. In making the determination to re-appoint Ernst & Young as Apple's independent registered public accounting firm, the Audit Committee considered, among other factors, the independence and performance of Ernst & Young and the quality of Ernst & Young's communications with the Audit Committee and the Board of Directors. Ernst & Young has served as Apple's independent registered public accounting firm since 2009. At the Annual Meeting, our shareholders

Apple Inc. is not independently the registered public accounting firm as Young as
Common #16-032126's Appointment of Ernst & #16A and Young is not required,
believe that the approval of ratification of the appointment is a good corporate governance
practice. In this proposal, the Audit Committee will reconsider its selection. Even if this appointment
Committee may, in its discretion, appoint a different independent registered public accounting firm at
any time the Audit Committee determines that it would be in the best interests of Apple and its
shareholders.

representatives of the Board and Young are expected to be present at the Annual Meeting, will have an Auditor's Report. The following table shows the fees paid to the Auditor for the years ended December 31, 2025, and 2024, as audited by a public accounting firm.

	2025 (\$)	2024 (\$)
Audit Fees (1)	24,703	22,381
Audit-Related Fees (2)	2,274	2,418
Tax Fees (3)	4,533	3,435
All Other Fees (4)	2,767	2,037
Total	34,277	30,271

(1) Audit fees relate to professional services rendered in connection with the audits of Apple's annual financial statements and internal control over financial reporting, quarterly review of financial statements, and audit services provided in connection with other statutory and regulatory filings. (2) Audit-related fees relate to professional services that are reasonably related to the performance of the audit or review of Apple's financial statements, and certain other assurance services required by statute or regulation. (3) Tax fees relate to professional services rendered in connection with tax compliance and preparation relating to tax returns and tax audits, as well as for tax consulting and planning services. Tax fees in 2025 include \$1.3 million for tax compliance projects and \$3.2 million for tax advisory projects. Tax fees in 2024 include \$1.0 million for tax compliance projects and \$2.4 million for tax advisory projects. (4) All other fees relate to professional services not included in the categories above, including services related to other permissible advisory services and regulatory reporting requirements, including operational audit services, and other assurance services that are not required by statute or regulation.

2026 Proxy Statement 65 Table of Contents Summary Governance Director Compensation Proposals Other Information Policy on Audit Committee Pre-Approval of Audit and Non-Audit

~~Serves performed by the Independent Registered Public Accounting Firm Apple maintains an auditor from performing non-audit services, prohibits Apple’s independent registered public accounting firm serving its policy on Apple's that as information technology consulting and internal audit expected to be performed each year by the audit and permissible non-audit services the period or register be provided with quarterly and the related budget, and that reporting into actual agreements with Apple’s independent that Apple may non-audit services without the express pre-approval of the Audit Committee.~~

in accordance with the policy, services performed by Apple and independent registered public accountants. The Board recommends a vote FOR Proposal No. 2. Vote Required Approval of Proposal No. 2 requires the affirmative vote of (i) a majority of the shares present or represented by proxy and voting at the Annual Meeting and (ii) a majority of the shares required to constitute a quorum. 66
2026 Proxy Statement Table of Contents Summary Governance Directors Compensation Proposals Other Information Proposal No. 3 Advisory Vote to Approve Executive Compensation In accordance with the requirements of

Section 1601 of the Exchange Act and the related rules of the SEC, our shareholders have the opportunity to approve the compensation of our named executive officers as disclosed in the proxy statement, including the compensation table and the Compensation Discussion and Analysis. Section 1601 of the Exchange Act and the related rules of the SEC also require us to disclose the compensation of our named executive officers in the proxy statement, including the compensation table and the Compensation Discussion and Analysis. Section 1601 of the Exchange Act and the related rules of the SEC also require us to disclose the compensation of our named executive officers in the proxy statement, including the compensation table and the Compensation Discussion and Analysis.

the Director may provide that any one share subject to a restricted stock unit award that is available for award shares the Director in determining the number of shares that shall again become exercisable for an option granted under the plan withheld by Apple to pay the withholding obligations exchange an award will satisfy available for the Compensation under the Discontinued Compensation payable services performed as a Non-Employee Director, including the grant date value (determined accepted a generally principles) of awards, cash retainers, and other compensation, exceed \$1.5 million in the aggregate. Administration The Administrator of the Plan is the Board. The Board has full authority to take any actions it deems necessary or advisable

Restricted stock units may be granted under the Director Plan. A restricted stock unit or "RSU" is a bookkeeping entry representing the equivalent of one share,

scheduled to meet on the date of grant, rounded to the nearest whole share. All Annual Director Awards are made to the Employee Directors who in the year ended 31st December have appeared at the Board and have been granted an award of £100,000 with an annual meeting of

Stock options are granted, the options exercise price not less than the fair market value of the stock on the date of grant, would be immediately vested unless otherwise specified at the time of grant and ten years from the date of grant. There are currently no stock options outstanding under the Director Plan; Restrictions on Transfer Except as described below, awards under the plan are generally not transferable by the recipient and, after the recipient's death, the award shall be exercisable by the Non-Employee Director. The Board has decided not to transfer to a Non-Employee Director's family members or to one or more of such family members. No Repricing No adjustment may be made to the plan or

any change, option or award under the Director Plan (by amendment, substitution, cancellation and regrant, adjustment or forfeiture) and the pricing of the per-share exercise price of the option except for an adjustment to reflect a change in the number of shares of common stock outstanding.

16.00 Termination of Service by Non-Employee Director approved by the Board for any reason other than death, that director's date of termination shall be the date on which the director ceased to be a member of the Board. Upon termination, the director shall have 90 days after the date of termination to exercise any options that have been granted to him or her. If the director does not exercise any options within 90 days after the date of termination, the options shall expire. The share limit and the number and kind of shares available under the Director Plan and any outstanding awards, as well as the number of shares of common stock that may be issued under the Director Plan, shall be determined as of the date of termination.

[illegible]

 At Apple, we believe business can and should be a force for good. Our teams around the world work to infuse Apple’s

products and services with everything we make. Apple engages with stakeholders as part of our commitment to transparency and accountability. We welcome dialogue, including regarding information about Apple’s policies and practices and to communicate our progress through

transparent reporting. The proposal below was submitted by

shareholder under Rule 14a-8 under the Exchange Act. This proposal, and the supporting statement, is included as required information in Apple’s opposition statement, as well as the Board’s voting

record. The proposal is highly prescriptive and attempts to inappropriately restrict Apple’s ability to manage its own ordinary business operations and business strategies. AGAINST In October 2025, the Company submitted

SEC’s Division of Corporation Finance asking the Staff to concur with the Company’s

proposal submitted to the Company for inclusion in the Proxy Statement could be properly excluded under SEC Rule 8. The Staff subsequently announced that they would not respond to most requests for exclusion of shareholder proposals

the proposal. Following that announcement, and based on the Company’s review of

that Staff guidance to the exclusion of Rule 14a-8, and judicial decisions, we determined

to share that the proposal was excluded because the proponent failed to provide required documentation

and related information. Any securities consistent with SEC Rule 14a-8

joint to the shareholder to explain exclusion to the Staff and the proponent, we reached out

proponents of the proposal to offer assistance. The proposal was submitted by a shareholder who has represented to Apple that they

have been the beneficial owner of a sufficient amount of the Company’s securities for a

period as required by Rule 14a-8. We will promptly provide you with the address and, to our knowledge, the

direct address of the proponent of the shareholder proposal upon receiving a written or oral request

SEC’s Division of Corporation Finance. The proposal requires the affirmative vote of

the majority of the shares present or represented by proxy and voting at the Annual Meeting and (ii) a majority of the shares

constitute a quorum. 74 2026 Proxy Statement Table of Contents Summary Governance Directors Compensation

Proposals Other Information Proposal No. 5 Shareholder Proposal Apple has been advised that the

National

Center for Public Policy Research. While the Willow Springs, IL, China trade tensions, Apple could

face steep tariff increases. Analysts warn tariffs on Chinese imports could hit as high as 145%, severely inflating

production costs. One article projects this could add \$10 billion annually to iPhone expenses. (1) ● While Apple is

apparently shifting some production to India and Vietnam, these regions still depend heavily on Chinese parts, and

manufacturing costs are 5–10% higher. (2) ● China may restrict support from Chinese engineers or

suppliers to Apple’s new operations in India—potentially delaying diversification plans. (3) ● Greater

China — encompassing Mainland China, Hong Kong, and Taiwan — accounted for nearly 20% of

Apple’s revenues—about \$74 billion annually. A regional conflict (e.g., over Taiwan) could abruptly

eliminate this, much like Russia-related disruptions did for others. (4) ● The Uyghur Forced Labor Prevention Act

further complicates matters. Chinese suppliers linked to Xinjiang’s labor practices face U.S. bans, risking supply

chain disruptions. Meanwhile, China’s control over rare earth minerals—essential for semiconductors and

sensors—gives it leverage to weaponize shortages. (5) ● Apple has previously been the target of Chinese

Espionage actions; the company’s proprietary data pertaining to its autonomous vehicles program was stolen in

2018 and 2019. (6) Since then, Chinese firms have become a global leader in autonomous vehicles, (7) potentially off the

back of Apple’s investment. ● “As Patrick McGee makes devastatingly clear in … Apple in

China , the American company’s decision … to manufacture about 90 percent of its products in China has

created an existential vulnerability not just for Apple, but for the United States—nurturing the conditions for Chinese

technology to outpace American innovation.” (8) ● Apple’s disclosures regarding the foregoing

issues have fallen short of adequately informing shareholders. (9) ● Insufficient disclosures can expose Apple to

additional litigation risk. (10) (1)

<https://www.ainvest.com/news/apple-china-dependency-strategic-time-bomb-investors-2505/> (2)

<https://www.ainvest.com/news/apple-china-dependency-strategic-time-bomb-investors-2505/> (3)

<https://timesofindia.indiatimes.com/technology/tech-news/how-and-why-china-not-donald-trump-may-be-bigger-threat-to-ap>

(4) <https://altimetry.com/articles/apples-china-problem-is-worse-than-it-seems> (5)

<https://www.ainvest.com/news/apple-china-dependency-strategic-time-bomb-investors-2505/> (6)

[illegible]

risks, and is supported by the Audit and Finance Committee, which has the primary responsibility for assisting Board with its risk oversight duties. Apple's Enterprise Risk Management Program is designed to identify significant business risks, including risks related to our international operations, and is supported by a Risk Oversight Committee, consisting of our Chief Financial Officer, General Counsel, Assurance, and other senior business leaders, that assists the Audit and Finance Committee with its general responsibility for overseeing enterprise risk management. Through these robust risk management and reporting systems,

Apple is able to continue to identify and seek to mitigate the risks of our international business operations program/ (2) supply chain reports. Apple 2026 Proxy Statement 77 Table of Contents Summary Governance Directors Compensation Proposals Other Information & Other Matters & Apple knows of no other matters to be submitted

matters proposed at the Annual Meeting, other than the proposals identified in this Proxy Statement. If any other voted in the shares presented the Annual Meeting, it is the intention of the persons named on the proxy to State on Table of Contents Summary Governance Directors Compensation Proposals Other Information & Other Information Audit and Finance Committee Report 80 Security Ownership of Certain Beneficial Owners and Management 81 Equity Compensation Plan Information 83 General Information 84 & 2026 Proxy Statement 79 Table of Contents Summary Governance Directors Compensation Proposals Other Information & Audit and Finance Committee Report & As of October 29, 2025, the date of this report, the Audit and Finance Committee has suggested that it serves as the Chair of the Committee, Wanda Austin, Monica Lozano and Sue Wang are independent director under Nasdaq and SEC rules and meets the standards for independence as set forth in Apple's Corporate Governance Guidelines. The Audit and Finance Committee has the

Apple's powers described in its written charter adopted by the Board. A copy of the charter is available on assist the Board's oversight and monitoring of & Apple's financial statements and other financial information provided by Apple to its shareholders and others; & compliance with legal, regulatory, and public disclosure requirements; & the independent auditors, including their qualifications and independence; & Apple's system of internal controls, including the internal audit function; & treasury and finance matters; & enterprise risk management, privacy, and data security; and the auditing, accounting, and financial reporting process generally. The Audit and Finance Committee does not itself prepare financial

statements of Apple's financial statements. The Audit and Finance Committee is responsible for the appointment,

public accounting firm of Ernst oversight of the work performed by Apple's independent registered carefully reviews the policies and oversight responsibility, the Audit and Finance Committee including the scope of the audit, of the independent registered public accounting firm, the extent to which the independent registered public independent auditors, and & Ernst & Young has served as Apple's independent registered public accounting firm since 2009 partner every five years. The Audit and Finance Committee oversight of the lead engagement partner. Apple maintains an auditor independence policy that, among other

things, it prohibits Apple's independent registered public accounting firm from performing non-financial Audit and Finance Committee consulting and internal audit services. This policy mandates that the independent registered public accounting firm's non-audit services to be performed by the provided with related by reporting to the Audit and Finance Committee be This policy is consistent with Apple's independent registered public accounting firm's pre-approval of the Audit and Finance Committee. The Audit and Finance Committee has reviewed and discussed the audited

financial statements with Ernst & Young September 27, 2025, with Apple's Matters required to be discussed by the audit firm discussed with Ernst & Young the (60220 PCAOB 2011) Company SEC filing. The Audit and Finance Committee has also received and reviewed the

regarding Ernst & Young's communication with the required by applicable requirements concerning independence, and has discussed with Ernst &

above, its independence. Based on the reviews and discussions referred to included in Apple's Annual Report to the Board that the financial statements referred to above be Report of the Audit and Finance Committee, September 27, 2025, Ron Sugaw (Chair) Wanda Austin Monica Lozano Sue

Wagner 80 2026 Proxy Statement Table of Contents Summary Governance Directors Compensation Proposals Other Information Security Ownership of Certain Beneficial Owners and Management The following table shows information as of January 2, 2026 (the “Table Date”), unless otherwise indicated, regarding

the beneficial ownership of Apple’s common stock by: (i) each person known to Apple to beneficially own more than 1% of Apple’s common stock based solely on Apple’s review of filings with the SEC pursuant to Section 13(d) of the Securities Exchange Act; (ii) each director and nominee; (iii) each executive officer; and (iv) all of the directors and executive officers as a group. As of the Table Date, 14,697,926,000 shares of Apple’s common stock were outstanding.

and of Apple’s common stock, all of which are held in the name of the beneficial owner. All persons named as beneficial owners have sole voting power and sole investment power with respect to the shares indicated.

As of the Table Date, the following table shows information regarding the beneficial ownership of Apple’s common stock:

Name of Beneficial Owner	Number of Shares of Common Stock Beneficially Owned (1)	Percent of Common Stock Outstanding The Vanguard Group
1,415,826,462 (2)	9.63%	BlackRock, Inc. 1,043,713,019 (3)
7.10%	Kate Adams 175,408 (4)	* Wanda Austin 2,843 (5)
* Tim Cook 3,280,295 (6)	* Alex Gorsky 6,794 (7)	* Andrea Jung 77,664 (8)
* Sabih Khan 1,074,404 (9)	* Art Levinson 4,126,689 (10)	* Monica Lozano 9,862 (11)
* Luca Maestri 91,304 (12)	* Deirdre O'Brien 136,687 (13)	* Kevan Parekh 8,765 (14)
* Ron Sugar 110,566 (15)	* Sue Wagner 69,788 (16)	* All current directors and executive officers as a group (12 persons)
9,079,765 (17)	* (1) Represents shares of Apple’s common stock held, and RSUs held that will vest within 60 days after the Table Date. Does not include RSUs that vest more than 60 days after the Table Date. RSUs are awards granted by Apple and payable, subject to vesting requirements, in shares of Apple’s common stock. (2) Represents shares of Apple’s common stock beneficially owned as of June 30, 2025, based on a Schedule 13G/A filed with the SEC on July 29, 2025, by The Vanguard Group. The Vanguard Group lists its address as 100 Vanguard Blvd., Malvern, PA 19355, and indicates that it has shared voting power with respect to 19,800,347 shares of Apple’s common stock, sole dispositive power with respect to 1,343,278,627 shares of Apple’s common stock, and shared dispositive power with respect to 72,547,835 shares of Apple’s common stock. (3) Represents shares of Apple’s common stock beneficially owned as of December 31, 2023, based on a Schedule 13G/A filed with the SEC on February 1, 2024, by BlackRock. BlackRock lists its address as 50 Hudson Yards, New York, NY 10001, and indicates that it has shared voting power with respect to 936,902,208 shares of Apple’s common stock, and sole dispositive power with respect to all shares beneficially owned. (4) Excludes 369,488 RSUs held by Ms. Adams that are not scheduled to vest within 60 days after the Table Date. (5) Includes 1,255 RSUs held by Dr. Austin that are scheduled to vest on February 1, 2026. (6) Represents 3,280,295 shares of Apple’s common stock held in the name of Mr. Cook’s trust and excludes 836,667 RSUs held by Mr. Cook that are not scheduled to vest within 60 days after the Table Date. (7) Includes 1,255 RSUs held by Mr. Gorsky that are scheduled to vest on February 1, 2026. (8) Includes 404 shares of Apple’s common stock held in the name of a family trust, and 1,255 RSUs held by Ms. Jung that are scheduled to vest on February 1, 2026. (9) Includes 31,632 shares of Apple’s common stock held by Mr. Khan’s family trust and excludes 369,488 RSUs held by Mr. Khan that are not scheduled to vest within 60 days after the Table Date. (10) Includes 56,000 shares of Apple’s common stock held by Dr. Levinson’s spouse and 1,113 RSUs held by Dr. Levinson that are scheduled to vest on February 1, 2026. (11) Includes 1,255 RSUs held by Ms. Lozano that are scheduled to vest on February 1, 2026. (12) Excludes 269,614 RSUs held by Mr. Maestri that are not scheduled to vest within 60 days after the Table Date. (13) Excludes 369,488 RSUs held by Ms. O'Brien that are not scheduled to vest within 60 days after the Table Date. (14) Excludes 203,473 RSUs held by Mr. Parekh that are not scheduled to vest within 60 days after the Table Date. (15) Includes 1,255 RSUs held by Dr. Sugar that are scheduled to vest on February 1, 2026. (16) Includes 6,042 shares of Apple’s common stock held by Ms. Wagner’s spouse and 1,255 RSUs held by Ms. Wagner that are scheduled to vest on February 1, 2026. (17) Includes 8,643 RSUs held by directors that are scheduled to vest within 60 days after the Table Date. As of the Table Date, no executive officer held any RSUs scheduled to vest within 60 days after the Table Date. Excludes 2,148,604 RSUs held by executive officers that are not scheduled to vest within 60 days after the Table Date. Does not include Mr. Maestri who transitioned from his role as Chief Financial Officer in January 2025. * Represents less than 1% of the issued and outstanding shares of Apple’s common stock as of the Table Date.	

 82 2026 Proxy Statement Table of Contents Summary Governance Directors Compensation Proposals Other Information Equity Compensation Plan Information The following table shows information, as of September 27, 2025, regarding the equity compensation plans of Apple’s common stock as of September 27, 2025, other than as described

Registered as outstanding awards granted under the Apple Inc. 2014 Employee Stock Plan (As Amended and \$1.267), and 249,955 shares were subject to outstanding options and 8,669,882 shares were which cashless exercise subject to outstanding awards granted under the Director Plan, of outstanding up to 88,573,348 shares available for issuance under the 2022 Plan, 48,575,220 shares reserved for issuance

Directors' Plan Share Employee Stock Purchase Plan, and 4,092,836 shares available for issuance under the 2022 Plan except the Directors other than stock options and stock appreciation rights granted under the Every share granted in 2026; 2026 A.P.L.O. Program #160; State applicability of Contents Summary Governance Directors Compensation Proposals Other Information General Information 2026 Annual Meeting of Shareholders Date and Time: February 24, 2026 8:00 A.M. Pacific Time Virtual Meeting Site: www.virtualshareholdermeeting.com/AAPL2026 The Record Date for the Annual Meeting is January 2, 2026. Only

[illegible]

ante past submit questions during the period 8:45-9:00 a.m. visiting www.aalshammeeting.com/aalsham, 2026 and enter the control number included in your Notice of Internet Availability of Proxy Materials, voting instruction form, or proxy card. Online access to the webcast will open approximately 15 minutes prior to the start of the Annual Meeting. Attendance at the Annual Meeting is subject to capacity limits set by the virtual meeting platform provider. To submit questions in advance

of the Annual Meeting, visit proxyvote.com before 8:59 P.M. Pacific Time on February 23, 2026, and enter your

If you have questions about proxyvote.com or your control number, please contact the bank, broker,

organizational chart The availability of online voting may depend on the voting procedures of the

records are #16065, which contain the agenda for the meeting, including agenda and

using one of the methods described in this Proxy Statement to ensure that your vote will be represented

Members may reserve the right to eject an attendee or cut off speaking privileges for behavior likely to cause disruption or annoyance or for failure to comply with reasonable requests or the rules of conduct for the meeting, including time limits applicable

to shareholders who are permitted to speak. We will endeavor to answer as many questions submitted by

questions regarding topics we reserve the right to edit profanity or other inappropriate language and to exclude

similar questions, even to a going concern or company business. If we receive substantially

of technical difficulties with the Response Meeting, repetition. ¶ In the event

expected that shareholder meeting will be held in April 2026#160;

regardless of the time and location of the Annual Meeting of the

also be posted on our investor Relations website at investor.apple.com. 84

2026;Proxy;Statement Table of Contents Summary Governance Directors Compensation Proposals Other Information ; Proxy Materials ; These materials were first sent or made available to shareholders

On January 8, 2026, a Proxy Statement for the Meeting and 2026 Annual Report on Form 10-K for the year ended September 27, 2025. If you requested printed versions by mail, these printed proxy materials

Statements & #160; This document includes the following statements with & #160; Form of the Private Securities Litigation Reform Act of 1995,

compensation programs, regarding statements, commitments, and strategies, and our executive involve risks and uncertainties. Actual results could differ materially from any

[illegible]

[illegible]

[illegible]

2026; Proxy; Statement Table of Contents Summary Governance Directors Compensation Proposals Other Information; Annex A; 2026; Proxy; Statement A-1 Table of Contents Summary Governance Directors Compensation Proposals Other Information; APPLE INC. NON-EMPLOYEE DIRECTOR STOCK PLAN; (as amended and restated on November 4, 2025); On November 4, 2025, the Board adopted this amended Apple Company 2021 Director Plan (the "2022 Plan") subject to and effective upon approval of the 2022 Director Stock Option Plan and February 24, 2026. The Plan was formerly known as Plan 1997 subject to a Stock Plan by the Company and was amended to the Share Employee terms and conditions of the Plan as of February 24, 2026. For an Award, refer to the version Award was granted as of the date of the Plan. The purposes of the Plan are to retain the services of qualified individuals who are not employees of the Company to serve as members of the Board and to secure for the Company the benefits of the incentives inherent in increased Common Stock ownership by such individuals by granting such individuals Awards in respect of Shares. 2. ADMINISTRATION . The Administrator shall be responsible for administering the Plan. Subject to the provisions of the Plan, the Administrator shall have the full authority, in its sole discretion, to take any actions it deems necessary or advisable for the administration of the Plan, including but not limited to: (a) determining the Fair Market Value for purposes of any Award; (b) approving any forms of Award Agreements to be used under the Plan; (c) amending any outstanding Awards; (d) construing and interpreting the Plan and any agreements defining the rights and obligations of the Company and Non-Employee Directors under the Plan; (e) correcting any defect, supplying any omission or reconciling any inconsistency in the Plan or any Award Agreement; (f) adopting such rules or guidelines as it deems appropriate to implement the Plan; (g) authorizing any person to execute on behalf of the Company any instrument required to effect the grant of an Award previously authorized by the Administrator or the Plan; (h) adjusting the number of shares subject to any Award, adjusting the price of any or all outstanding Options or otherwise changing previously imposed terms and conditions, in such circumstances as the Administrator may deem appropriate; (i) determining whether, and the extent to which, adjustments are required pursuant to Section 7 hereof; and (j) making all other decisions relating to the operation of the Plan. Each interpretation, determination, or other action made or taken by the Administrator pursuant to the Plan shall be a determination of the Administrator and shall be final and not subject to review by the Board. The Administrator shall be liable for any action or determination made in good faith and shall be exempt from liability in the manner provided in the Company's Articles of Incorporation and Bylaws as amended from time to time. 3. SHARES AVAILABLE; LIMITS . (a) SHARE LIMIT . Subject to the provisions of Section 7, the maximum number of Shares that may be issued under the Plan shall not exceed 44,800,000 Shares (the "Share Limit"). The stock issuable under the Plan shall be authorized and unissued Shares. (b) SHARE COUNT . Shares issued pursuant to Restricted Stock Unit Awards shall count against the Share Limit as two (2) Shares for every one (1) Share issued in connection with the Award. Shares issued pursuant to the exercise of Options shall count against the Share Limit as one (1) Share for every one (1) Share to which such exercise relates. If Awards are settled in cash, the shares that would have been delivered had there been no cash settlement shall not be counted against the Share Limit. Except as provided in the next sentence, if Awards are forfeited or are terminated for any reason before settlement or exercise, then the Shares underlying such Awards shall again become available for Awards under the Plan, provided that any one (1) Share subject to a Restricted Stock Unit Award that is forfeited or terminated shall be credited as two (2) Shares when determining the number of Shares that shall again become available for Awards under the Plan. Shares that are exchanged by a Non-Employee Director or withheld by the Company as full or partial payment in connection with any Award under the Plan, as well as any Shares exchanged by a Non-Employee Director or withheld by the Company or one of its Subsidiaries to satisfy the tax withholding obligations related to any Award, shall not be available for subsequent Awards under the Plan. (c) LIMIT ON COMPENSATION . In no event shall the compensation payable by the Company to a Non-Employee Director for services performed as a Non-Employee Director, including the grant date value (determined under U.S. generally accepted accounting principles) of Awards, cash retainers, and other compensation, exceed \$1,500,000 in the aggregate in any fiscal year. 4. RESTRICTED STOCK UNITS . Unless otherwise determined by the Administrator, each Non-Employee Director shall receive grants of Restricted Stock Units under the Plan subject to the following provisions of this Section 4 and the terms of any Award Agreement immediately following initiation of the Plan. (a) Non-Employee Director's Service Award . The Board shall automatically grant an Award of a number of Restricted Stock Units determined by dividing (i) \$310,000 (or such other amount as determined by the Board prior to the date of such Annual Meeting and subject to the limitations of the Plan) by

(ii) the Fair Market Value of the Shares on the date of grant, such number to be rounded to the nearest whole number of Restricted Stock Units (each, an "Annual RSU Award");

(b) INITIAL GRANTS . Each Non-Employee Director who first becomes a Non-Employee Director at any time other than on the date of an Annual Meeting shall be automatically granted, on the date he or she first becomes a Non-Employee Director, an Award of a number of Restricted Stock Units determined by multiplying (i) the quotient obtained by dividing (A) the dollar amount applied under Section 4(a) with respect to Awards granted at the immediately preceding Annual Meeting by (B) the Fair Market Value of the Shares on the date of grant, by (ii) a fraction (A) the numerator of which shall be the number of days remaining in the 365-day period following the most recent Annual Meeting, and (B) the denominator of which shall be 365 (but in no event shall such fraction be greater than one (1)), such number to be rounded to the nearest whole number of Restricted Stock Units (each, an "Initial RSU Award"); provided, however, that a Non-Employee Director shall not be eligible to receive an Initial RSU Award if either (x) he or she was an employee of the Company or any of its Subsidiaries immediately prior to first becoming a Non-Employee Director, or (y) he or she first becomes a Non-Employee Director at any time on or after the February 1 following the last preceding Annual Meeting.

(c) VESTING; TERMINATION OF SERVICE . Except as otherwise provided in an Award Agreement at the time of grant, each Annual RSU Award shall fully vest on the February 1 that occurs in the fiscal year of the Company following the fiscal year in which the Award was granted. Each Initial RSU Award shall fully vest on the Vesting Date established for the Annual RSU Awards granted in connection with the last Annual Meeting to occur prior to the grant date of such Initial RSU Award. If the Non-Employee Director ceases to serve as a member of the Board for any reason other than the Non-Employee Director's death, the Non-Employee Director's Restricted Stock Units shall terminate to the extent such Restricted Stock Units have not become vested prior to the first date the Non-Employee Director is no longer a member of the Board, and the Non-Employee Director shall have no rights with respect to, or in respect of, such terminated Restricted Stock Units. If the Non-Employee Director ceases to serve as a member of the Board due to his or her death, the Non-Employee Director's unvested Restricted Stock Units shall fully vest as of the date of the Non-Employee Director's death.

(d) SETTLEMENT OF RESTRICTED STOCK UNITS . On or as soon as administratively practical following the applicable Vesting Date (and in all events not later than two and one-half months after the applicable Vesting Date), the Company shall deliver to the Non-Employee Director a number of Shares (as evidenced by an appropriate entry on the books of the Company or a duly authorized transfer agent of the Company) equal to the number of Restricted Stock Units that vested on the applicable Vesting Date. Upon settlement of any Restricted Stock Units in accordance with the foregoing provision of this Section 4(d) and settlement of any Dividend Equivalent Right in accordance with Section 4(f), the Non-Employee Director shall have no further rights with respect to any Restricted Stock Units that are so paid.

(e) SHAREHOLDER RIGHTS . A Non-Employee Director shall have no rights as a shareholder of the Company, no dividend rights (except as expressly set forth in Section 4(f) with respect to Dividend Equivalent Rights) and no voting rights with respect to the Restricted Stock Units or any Shares underlying or issuable in respect of such Restricted Stock Units until such Shares have been issued to the Non-Employee Director pursuant to Section 4(d). Except for any Dividend Equivalent Rights awarded pursuant to Section 4(f) or as provided in Section 7, no adjustment shall be made in respect of any Restricted Stock Units for dividends or distributions or other rights in respect of any share for which the record date is prior to the date upon which the Non-Employee Director shall become the holder of record of Shares related thereto.

(f) DIVIDEND EQUIVALENT RIGHTS DISTRIBUTIONS . As of any date that the Company pays an ordinary cash dividend on its Common Stock, the Company shall credit the Non-Employee Directors with a dollar amount equal to (i) the per Share cash dividend paid by the Company on its Common Stock on such date, multiplied by (ii) the total number of Restricted Stock Units (including as such total number may be adjusted pursuant to Section 7) subject to the Award that are outstanding on the record date for that dividend (a "Dividend Equivalent Right"). Any Dividend Equivalent Rights credited pursuant to the foregoing provisions of this Section 4(f) shall be subject to the same vesting, settlement and other terms, conditions and restrictions as the Restricted Stock Units to which they relate; provided, however, that the amount of any vested Dividend Equivalent Rights shall be paid in cash. No crediting of Dividend Equivalent Rights shall be made pursuant to this Section 4(f) with respect to any Restricted Stock Units which, immediately prior to the record date for that dividend, have either been paid pursuant to Section 4(d) or terminated pursuant to Section 4(c).

5. OPTIONS .

(a) NO ADDITIONAL GRANTS . No Options shall be granted under the Plan unless and until the Board determines that the grant of Options is in the best interests of the Company and its shareholders.

(b) EXERCISE PRICE . The per share exercise price of each Option shall not be less than 100% of the Fair Market Value of a Share as of the date of grant of the Option determined in accordance with the provisions of the Plan.

(c) VESTING . Except as otherwise provided in an Award Agreement at the time of grant, Options shall be fully vested and immediately exercisable on their date of grant.

(d) TERM OF OPTIONS .

 i. TEN-YEAR TERM . Each Option shall expire ten (10) years from its date of grant, subject to earlier termination as provided herein. ii. TERMINATION OF SERVICE . Upon cessation of a Non-Employee Director’s service as a member of the Board for any reason other than death, any of the Non-Employee Director’s Options (or any portion thereof) that is not then vested shall terminate, and the Non-Employee Director shall have no rights with respect to, or in respect of, such terminated Options. If the Non-Employee Director ceases to serve as a member of the Board due to his or her death, the Non-Employee Director’s Options shall fully vest as of the date of the Non-Employee Director’s death. iii. EXERCISE FOLLOWING TERMINATIONS OF SERVICE . If a Non-Employee Director ceases to be a member of the Board for any reason other than death, any Options granted to such Non-Employee Director that are exercisable at the time of the Non-Employee Director’s termination may be exercised by such Non-Employee Director at any time within ninety (90) days after the date of such Non-Employee Director’s termination of service, subject to the earlier expiration of such Options as provided for in Section 5(d)(i) above. At the end of such ninety-day period, any unexercised portion of the Option shall expire. If a Non-Employee Director ceases to be a member of the Board by reason of such Non-Employee Director’s death, all of the Options granted to the Non-Employee Director may be exercised by his or her Beneficiary at any time within three (3) years after the date of the Non-Employee Director’s death, subject to the earlier expiration of such Options as provided for in Section 5(d)(i) above. At the end of such three (3)-year period, any unexercised portion of the Option shall expire. (e) TIME AND MANNER OF EXERCISE OF OPTIONS . i. NOTICE OF EXERCISE . Subject to the other terms and conditions hereof, a Non-Employee Director may exercise any Option, to the extent such Option is vested, by giving written notice of exercise to the Company; provided, however, that in no event shall an Option be exercisable for a fractional share. The date of exercise of an Option shall be the later of (A) the date on which the Company receives such written notice and (B) the date on which the Non-Employee Director pays the applicable consideration pursuant to Section 5(e)(ii). ii. METHOD OF EXERCISE . The consideration to be paid for the Shares to be issued upon exercise of an Option may consist of (A) cash, (B) check, (C) other Shares that have a Fair Market Value on the date of surrender equal to the aggregate exercise price of the Shares as to which the Option shall be exercised, (D) delivery of a properly executed exercise notice together with irrevocable instructions to a broker to sell Shares and promptly deliver to the Company the amount of proceeds required to pay the exercise price, or (E) any combination of the foregoing methods of payment. Without limiting the generality of the foregoing, any vested and exercisable Options may also be Net Exercised, to the extent permitted by the Administrator. 2026 Proxy Statement A-5 Table of Contents Summary Governance Directors Compensation Proposals Other Information iii. SHAREHOLDER RIGHTS . A Non-Employee Director shall have no rights as a shareholder with respect to any Shares issuable upon exercise of an Option until such Shares shall have been issued to the Non-Employee Director pursuant to Section 5(e), and, except as provided in Section 7, no adjustment shall be made to an Option or Share issued upon the exercise thereof for dividends, distributions or other rights in respect of any Share for which the record date is prior to the date upon which the Non-Employee Director shall become the holder of record thereof. (f) ISSUANCE OF SHARES . Subject to the foregoing conditions, as soon as is reasonably practicable after its receipt of a proper notice of exercise and, if applicable, payment of the exercise price of the Option for the number of Shares with respect to which the Option is exercised, the Company shall deliver to the Non-Employee Director (or following the Non-Employee Director’s death, the Beneficiary entitled to exercise the Option), at the principal office of the Company or at such other location as may be acceptable to the Company and the Non-Employee Director (or such Beneficiary), the appropriate number of Shares to be issued in connection with such exercise. Delivery of such Shares shall be evidenced by an appropriate entry on the books of the Company or a duly authorized transfer agent of the Company, or in such other manner that the Administrator shall specify from time to time. Shares sold in connection with a “cashless exercise” shall be delivered to the broker referred to therein in accordance with procedures established by the Company from time to time. 6. RESTRICTIONS ON TRANSFER . An Award may not be transferred, pledged, assigned, or otherwise disposed of, except by will or by the laws of descent and distribution; provided, however, that, with the approval of the Administrator, an Award may be transferred to a Non-Employee Director’s family members or to one or more trusts established in whole or in part for the benefit of one or more of such family members. An Option shall be exercisable, during the Non-Employee Director’s lifetime, only by the Non-Employee Director or by the individual or entity to whom the Option has been transferred in accordance with the previous sentence. No assignment or transfer of an Award, or of the rights represented thereby, whether voluntary or involuntary, by operation of law or otherwise, except by will or the laws of descent and distribution, shall vest in the assignee or transferee any interest or right in the Award, but immediately upon any attempt to assign or transfer the Award the same shall terminate and be of no force or effect. 7. ADJUSTMENTS . (a) Upon (or, as may be necessary to effect the adjustment, immediately prior to) any reclassification, recapitalization, stock split (including a stock split in the form of a stock dividend) or reverse stock split; any merger, combination, consolidation or other reorganization; any spin-off, split-up, split-off or extraordinary dividend distribution in respect of the Common Stock; or any exchange of Common Stock or other securities

of the Company, or any similar, unusual or extraordinary corporate transaction in respect of the Common Stock, the Administrator shall equitably and proportionately adjust (1) the number and type of Shares (or other securities) that thereafter may be made the subject of Awards (including the Share Limit, maximums and number of Shares set forth elsewhere in the Plan), (2) the number, amount and type of Shares (or other securities or property) subject to any outstanding Awards, (3) the exercise price of any outstanding Options, and/or (4) the securities, cash or other property deliverable upon exercise or settlement of any outstanding Awards, in each case to the extent necessary to preserve (but not increase) the level of incentives intended by the Plan and the then-outstanding Awards. Any good faith determination by the Administrator as to whether an adjustment is required in the circumstances pursuant to this Section 7(a), and the extent and nature of any such adjustment, shall be conclusive and binding on all persons. (b) It is intended that, unless otherwise determined by the Administrator, any adjustments contemplated by Section 7(a) be made in a manner that satisfies applicable legal, tax (including, without limitation and as applicable in the circumstances, Code Section 409A) and accounting (so as to not trigger any charge to earnings with respect to such adjustment) requirements. (c) Any adjustment under this Section 7 need not be the same for all persons or Awards. A-6 2026 Proxy Statement Table of Contents Summary Governance Directors Compensation Proposals Other Information 8. CHANGE OF CONTROL . Upon the occurrence of any Change of Control, any then outstanding Award automatically shall become vested or exercisable, as the case may be, with respect to a prorated portion of the number of Shares subject to such Award, determined as follows: (a) CLIFF-VESTING AWARDS . If the Award has one scheduled Vesting Date, the portion of the Award with respect to the following number of Shares shall vest upon the Change of Control: (i) the number of Shares subject to such Award, multiplied by (ii) a fraction (A) the numerator of which is the number of days elapsed from and including the date the Award was granted to the date of the Change of Control, and (B) the denominator is the number of days from and including the date of grant to and including the scheduled Vesting Date. (b) INSTALLMENT-VESTING AWARDS . If the Award has multiple scheduled Vesting Dates, the portion of the Award with respect to the following number of Shares shall vest upon the Change of Control: (i) the number of Shares subject to the portion of such Award that is scheduled to vest on the first Vesting Date that is scheduled to occur following the Change of Control, multiplied by (ii) a fraction (A) the numerator of which is the number of days elapsed following and excluding the most recent Vesting Date prior to the Change of Control, and (B) the denominator is the number of days from and excluding such most recent Vesting Date to and including the first Vesting Date that is scheduled to occur following the Change of Control. 9. DESIGNATION OF BENEFICIARY . (a) BENEFICIARY DESIGNATIONS . Each Non-Employee Director may designate a Beneficiary to exercise an Option or receive settlement of an Award upon the Non-Employee Director’s death by executing a Beneficiary Designation Form and delivering it to the Administrator. (b) CHANGE OF BENEFICIARY DESIGNATION . A Non-Employee Director may change an earlier Beneficiary designation by executing a later Beneficiary Designation Form and delivering it to the Administrator. The execution of a Beneficiary Designation Form and its receipt by the Administrator shall revoke and rescind any prior Beneficiary Designation Form. 10. TERMINATION AND AMENDMENT OF THE PLAN . (a) TERMINATION . Unless earlier terminated by the Board, the Plan shall terminate on February 23, 2036. Following such date, no further grants

~~GENERAL POWER OF BOARD~~ Notwithstanding any other provision of the Plan, the Board may at any time and from time to time terminate, modify, suspend or amend the Plan in whole or in part (including amend the Plan at any time and from time to time, without shareholder approval, to prospectively change the value and relative mixture of Restricted Stock Units and Options subject to Awards granted to Non-Employee Directors on the date of each Annual Meeting or upon becoming a Non-Employee Director and the methodology for determining the number of Shares to be subject to such Awards, each within the Share Limit and the individual limit set forth in Section 3, and the other terms and conditions applicable to such Awards) or, subject to Sections 10(c) and 10(d), amend the terms of any outstanding Award; provided, however, that no such termination, modification, suspension or amendment shall be effective without shareholder approval if such approval is required to comply with any applicable law or stock exchange rule; and provided further that the Board may not, without shareholder approval, increase the maximum number of Shares issuable under the Plan except as provided in Section 7. For avoidance of doubt, the Board may, without shareholder approval, provide on a prospective basis for grants under the Plan to consist of Options only, Restricted Stock Units only, or a combination of Options and Restricted Stock Units on such terms and conditions, subject to the Share Limit and the other express limits of the Plan, as may be established by the Board. 2026 Proxy Statement A-7 Table of Contents Summary Governance Directors Compensation Proposals Other Information (c) WHEN NON-EMPLOYEE DIRECTORS’ CONSENTS REQUIRED . The Board may not alter, amend, suspend or terminate the Plan, or amend the terms of any outstanding Award, without the consent of any Non-Employee Director to the extent that such action would adversely affect his or her rights with respect to Awards that have previously been granted, except to the extent such action is necessary to comply with applicable law or stock exchange listing rules or accounting rules. (d) NO REPRICING . In no case (except due to an adjustment contemplated by Section 7 or any

repricing that may be approved by shareholders) shall any action be taken with respect to the Plan or any Option hereunder that would constitute a repricing (by amendment, substitution, cancellation and regrant, exchange or other means, including any action that is treated as a repricing under U.S. generally accepted accounting principles) of the per Share exercise price of any Option. 11. MISCELLANEOUS . (a) NO RIGHT TO NOMINATION . Nothing in the Plan shall be deemed to create any obligation on the part of the Board to nominate any of its members for reelection by the Company’s shareholders, nor confer upon any Non-Employee Director the right to remain a member of the Board for any period of time, or at any particular rate of compensation. (b) REGULATORY REQUIREMENTS . The Administrator may require each Non-Employee Director or any other person purchasing or acquiring Shares pursuant to the Plan to agree with the Company in writing that such Non-Employee Director is acquiring the Shares for investment and not with a view to the distribution thereof or provide such other assurances and representations to the Company as the Administrator may deem necessary or desirable to assure compliance with all applicable legal and accounting requirements. Shares delivered under the Plan shall be subject to such stock-transfer orders and other restrictions as the Administrator may deem advisable under the rules, regulations and other requirements of the Securities and Exchange Commission or any exchange upon which the Common Stock is then listed, and any applicable federal or state securities law. No Shares shall be issued hereunder unless the Company shall have determined that such issuance is in compliance with, or pursuant to an exemption from, all applicable federal and state securities laws. (c) EXPENSES . The costs and expenses of administering the Plan shall be borne by the Company. (d) APPLICABLE LAW . Except as to matters of federal law, the Plan and all actions taken thereunder shall be governed by and construed in accordance with the laws of the State of California and applicable U.S. federal laws without giving effect to conflicts of law principles. (e) SEVERABILITY . If a court of competent jurisdiction holds any provision invalid and unenforceable, the remaining provisions of the Plan shall continue in effect. (f) SECTION HEADINGS; INTERPRETATION . Captions and headings are given to the sections and subsections of the Plan solely as a convenience to facilitate reference. Such headings shall not be deemed in any way material or relevant to the construction or interpretation of the Plan or any provision thereof. A-8 2026 Proxy Statement Table of Contents Summary Governance Directors Compensation Proposals Other Information (g) AUTHORITY OF THE COMPANY AND SHAREHOLDERS . The existence of the Plan shall not affect or restrict in any way the right or power of the Company or the shareholders of the Company to make or authorize (i) any adjustment, recapitalization, reorganization or other change in the Company’s capital structure or business of the Company or any Subsidiary, (ii) any merger, amalgamation, consolidation or change in the ownership of the Company or any Subsidiary, (iii) any issue of bonds, debentures, capital, preferred or prior preference stock ahead of or affecting the capital stock (or the rights thereof) of the Company or any Subsidiary, (iv) any dissolution or liquidation of the Company or any Subsidiary, (v) any sale or transfer of all or any part of the assets or business of the Company or any Subsidiary, (vi) the payment at the discretion of the Board of any type or form of compensation to Non-Employee Directors that may be made at law and without contravention of any requirement of the principal exchange upon which the Shares are traded, or (vii) any other corporate act or proceeding by the Company or any Subsidiary, whether of a similar character or otherwise. No Non-Employee Director, beneficiary or other person shall have any claim under any Award or Award Agreement against any member of the Board or the Company, or any employees, officers or agents of the Company or any Subsidiary, as a result of any such action. 12. DEFINITIONS . Capitalized words not otherwise defined in the Plan have the meanings set forth below: “ADMINISTRATOR” means the Board. The Board may delegate non-discretionary functions to individuals who are officers or employees of the Company or any of its Subsidiaries or third parties. “ANNUAL MEETING” means the first annual meeting of the Shareholders’ which members of the Board are elected following the applicable fiscal year of the Company or applicable date, as the context may require. By way of example, the Annual Meeting following the Company’s 2016 fiscal year was held on February 28, 2017. “AWARD” means an award of Options or Restricted Stock granted under the Plan. “AWARD AGREEMENT” means any agreement that evidences an Award granted under the Plan. Award Agreements shall consist of either (1) a written award agreement in a form approved by the Board, or (2) an electronic notice of award grant in a form approved by the Administrator and recorded by the Company in its electronic recordkeeping system used for the purpose of tracking award grants under the Plan generally, or (3) an electronic notice of award grant in a form approved by the Administrator and recorded by the Company in its electronic recordkeeping system used for the purpose of tracking award grants under the Plan generally, in each case and if required by the Administrator, may be in a form approved by the Administrator. “BENEFICIARY” means an individual designated by a Non-Employee Director or a Beneficiary Designation Form to exercise Options or receive settlement of Awards in the event of the death of a Non-Employee Director’s death; provided, however, that, if no such individual or entity is designated or if no such designated individual is alive at the time of the Non-Employee Director’s death, Beneficiary shall mean the Non-Employee Director’s estate. “BENEFICIARY DESIGNATION FORM” means a form approved by the Administrator to be used by Non-Employee Directors to name their respective

Designated by the Administrator prior to the date of the filing of this Statement A-9 Table of Contents Summary Governance Directors Compensation Proposals Other Information “CHANGE OF CONTROL” means the occurrence of any one of the following events: (i) the acquisition of (b)(3) or 14(d)(2) of the Exchange Act) (an “ Acquirer ”) of beneficial ownership (within the meaning of Rule 13d-3 promulgated under the Exchange Act) of 50% or more of either (1) the then outstanding Shares (the “ Outstanding Company Common Stock ”) or (2) the combined voting power of the then outstanding voting securities of the Company entitled to vote generally in the election of directors (the “ Outstanding Company Voting Securities ”); provided, however, that for purposes of this subsection (i), the following acquisitions shall not constitute a Change of Control: (1) any acquisition directly from the Company, (2) any acquisition by the Company, (3) any acquisition by any employee benefit plan (or related trust) sponsored or maintained by the Company or any entity controlled by the Company, or (4) any acquisition by any entity pursuant to a transaction that complies with clauses (1), (2) and (3) of subsection (iii) of this definition; (ii) A change in the composition of the Board such that the individuals who, as of February 13, 2018, constitute the Board (the “ Incumbent Board ”) cease for any reason to constitute at least a majority of the Board; provided, however, that, for purposes of this subsection (ii), any individual who becomes a member of the Board subsequent to February 13, 2018 whose election, or nomination for election by the Company’s shareholders, was approved by a vote of at least a majority of those individuals who are members of the Board and who were also members of the Incumbent Board (or deemed to be such pursuant to this proviso) shall be considered members of the Incumbent Board; provided further, that any such individual whose initial assumption of office occurs as a result of either an actual or threatened election contest with respect to the election or removal of directors or other actual or threatened solicitation of proxies or consents by or on behalf of an Acquirer other than the Board shall not be considered a member of the Incumbent Board; (iii) The consummation of a reorganization, merger, statutory share exchange or consolidation or similar transaction involving the Company or any of its Subsidiaries or sale or other disposition of all or substantially all of the assets of the Company, or the acquisition of assets or securities of another entity by the Company or any of its Subsidiaries (a “ Business Combination ”); in each case, unless, following such Business Combination (1) all or substantially all of the individuals and entities who were the beneficial owners, respectively, of the Outstanding Company Common Stock and Outstanding Company Voting Securities immediately prior to such Business Combination beneficially own, directly or indirectly, more than 50% of, respectively, the then outstanding shares of common stock (or, for a noncorporate entity, equivalent securities) and the combined voting power of the then outstanding voting securities entitled to vote generally in the election of directors (or, for a noncorporate entity, equivalent securities), as the case may be, of the entity resulting from such Business Combination (including an entity that, as a result of such transaction, owns the Company or all or substantially all of the Company’s assets either directly or through one or more subsidiaries) in substantially the same proportions as their ownership, immediately prior to such Business Combination of the Outstanding Company Common Stock and Outstanding Company Voting Securities, as the case may be, (2) no Acquirer (excluding any entity resulting from such Business Combination or any employee benefit plan (or related trust) of the Company or such entity resulting from such Business Combination) beneficially owns, directly or indirectly, 50% or more of, respectively, the then outstanding shares of common stock (or, for a noncorporate entity, equivalent securities) of the entity resulting from such Business Combination or the combined voting power of the then outstanding voting securities of such entity except to the extent that such ownership existed prior to the Business Combination, and (3) at least a majority of the members of the board of directors (or, for a noncorporate entity, equivalent body or committee) of the entity resulting from such Business Combination were members of the Incumbent Board at the time of the execution of the initial agreement, or of the action of the Board, providing for such Business Combination; or (iv) The approval by the shareholders of the Company of a complete liquidation or dissolution of the Company. A-10 2026 Proxy Statement Table of Contents Summary Governance Directors Compensation Proposals Other Information “CODE” means the Internal Revenue Code of 1986, as amended, and the regulations promulgated thereunder. “COMMON STOCK” means the common stock of the Company under the Plan that securities of the Company or any successor in interest thereto to which any award by a California corporation, under Section 5 “COMPANY” means Apple – Inc. – and its – subsidiaries – and the applicable rules and regulations – “FAIR MARKET VALUE” means, unless otherwise provided by the Administrator in the circumstances, the last price (in regular trading) for a Share on the Nasdaq Stock Market (the “ Market ”) for the date in question or, if no sales of Shares were reported on the Market that date, the last price (in regular trading) for a Share on the Market for the next preceding day on which sales of

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